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Virginia Board of Education, Business Meeting, Wednesday, August 17, 2022

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- Official meeting video (VDOE, YouTube): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=LYT9-P5_gHc
- Board of Education meetings, agendas and minutes (VDOE): https://www.doe.virginia.gov/state-board-data-funding/virginia-board-of-education

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[00:02:38] do you have a motion to read mr president we convened today in a closed meeting pursuant to a recorded vote on the motion above and in accordance with the freedom of information act section 2.2-3712 of the code of virginia requires that the board certify that to the best of each member's knowledge only public business matters lawfully exempt from open meeting requirements under this chapter and only such public business matters were identified in the motion by which the closed meeting was convened were heard discussed or considered any member who believes there was a departure from these requirements shall so state prior to the vote indicating the substance of departure and his or her judgment has taken place the statement of

[00:03:17] the departure will be recorded in the minutes vote of certification by roll call vote absolutely by roll call mr rotherham aye miss dada aye hanson aye dr siebert aye miss creasy chair votes aye okay oh i'm sorry i forgot you guys were here out of sight out of mind miss holton aye Dr. Davis Vaught aye and Dr. Mann aye you know sometimes you got to be present to win guys

[00:03:53] so a word of warning there but thank you all right uh we're going to push believe it or not item a down further on the agenda we've asked staff to look at a few things uh and so we're going to pick up now

with item c final review of a proposal to adopt special provisions regarding accreditation indicators uh msika and in the event oh actually pause on that sorry like now

[00:04:29] sorry amy we're gonna we're gonna put you what oh i gotta tell you this group would not be good at television production because we're just way way off on our timing marks all right no you're gonna stand and but you may be interrupted okay and you'll know what we're talking about when you see it and at that point we're going to swap you out and then bring you back how's that and welcome and good morning all right good morning all right afternoon now yikes good afternoon i guess it is

[00:05:06] good afternoon president kecker members of the board and superintendent baylow the purpose of today's presentation is to present a final review of a proposal to adopt special provisions regarding accreditation indicators this item was presented for first review in june the standards of accreditation do provide the board the authority to adopt special provisions related to the measurement and use of school quality indicators as well as the authority to alter inclusions and exclusions from the performance level

[00:05:42] calculations today the department is asking you to adopt special provisions for two indicators the first proposal regards the achievement gap indicators for English and mathematics and the use of failing Virginia alternate assessment program test scores also known as vap scores the vap tests are alternate state assessments given to students with significant cognitive disabilities the other proposal relates to adding an additional qualifying criteria to the college career and civic readiness index also known as the cccri

[00:06:20] the cccri is an indicator that is cohort based and the index is a measure of students receiving credit for advanced coursework earning cte credentials or participating in work-based or service learning experiences the cccri is not yet active but will count in accreditation calculations beginning in accreditation year 2324. i'll first present the proposal regarding

[00:06:53] vap as a little bit of background in 2020 2021 the new vap assessments were implemented for the first time previously the vap assessments were portfolio based and now the reading mathematics and science assessments are multiple choice tests in virginia's accreditation system we use a combined rate for the academic achievement indicators in grades three through eight reading and mathematics the combined rate in part includes students who passed state assessments which are sol

[00:07:28] tests and the vap tests as well as students who fail the assessments but show growth since this is the first year for the new vap tests the students who took this test and failed were unable to show growth from the previous year as this was the first year for the new test in addition i'd like to point out that the accreditation indicators receive a performance level rating of either a level one which means the performance rate meets or exceeds the state benchmark a level two which means the performance rate is near the state

[00:08:04] benchmark or a level three which means the performance rate is well below the benchmark with that bit of background information the proposal regarding the VAP assessments is on the screen the department requests that failing VAP test records be removed from the determination of the performance level for the student group students with disabilities in the achievement gap English and achievement gap mathematics indicators for this current accreditation year 22-23 only when the performance level for that student group is a level 3 and the rating is based solely on failing VAP test records I'll

[00:08:43] provide some graphics on the next two slides to specifically demonstrate how this proposal would be implemented since the number of VAP assessments hover around 1% of the Virginia student population the impact of not being able to show growth on a failing test record in the combined rate for the academic achievement english and mathematics indicators is minimized because of the group size those indicators are reported for all students however this may not be the case when looking at student groups within

[00:09:17] the achievement gap indicators as the numbers in each group can be relatively small on the screen is a snapshot from a school accreditation detail report for achievement gap in english you'll notice that the student groups are each designated a performance level based on the performance rate for the group. The overall performance level is based on a set of decision rules that is applied across all the student groups. Having one group at a level three places the overall performance level at a level two, and having two or more student groups at a level three

[00:09:52] places the overall performance level at a level three. In this example, the overall performance level was a level two because one of the indicators had a level three rating and it was the students with disabilities group what is being proposed is demonstrated by the example on the screen this is a snapshot from the accreditation detail report for achievement gap english for the students with disabilities group i'd like to draw your attention to the two far right columns which indicate the combined rate and the performance level you'll notice in the top image the combined

[00:10:30] rate is 64.44 percent and the performance level is a level three in this data there are several vap students who failed and were unable to show growth due to the new test format when the students are removed from the number of students tested and the combined rate is recalculated it's 69.71 which is in the level 2 performance range if you look at the second image the rate of 64.44 is still reported but the performance level designation is changed to a level two the

[00:11:06] proposal states that if failing vap scores are the sole reason for a level three designation in the students with disabilities group then the performance level will be reassigned based on a combined rate calculation that does not include the failing vap assessments however the reported values will not change and will include the failing vap scores this will maintain transparency of the actual earned combined rate while also mitigating the accreditation impact of a new vap assessment on schools in the students with disabilities student group this proposal

[00:11:42] only applies to accreditation year 22-23 and in accreditation year 23-24 year-over-year growth will be determined by comparing performance on the spring 22 vap assessment to the spring 23 vap assessment the next provision that is being requested of the board regards the college career and civic readiness index the proposal is to add a qualifying criteria to the cccri beginning in accreditation year 2324 calculation of the cccri is on the unduplicated count of students who meet

[00:12:21] at least one qualifying criteria these students are placed in the numerator and you divide that that by the total number of students in the on-time graduation cohort which is the denominator currently a student is included in the numerator if they can successfully complete one of these qualifying criteria an advanced placement international baccalaureate cambridge or dual enrollment course two or more standard credits for a state approved sequence in a cte program and they earn a cte credential or a student completes a work-based or service learning

[00:13:00] experience the proposal in front of you today is to add a jrotc sequence plus a credential to the list of qualifying criteria for this indicator jrotc is a nationally valued program that prepares students for post high school success by promoting academics leadership integrity personal accountability civic responsibility and community service the jrotc program is intended to prepare students for college career and civic duty a qualifying jrotc student would be one that

[00:13:36] has successfully completed at least three years of jrotc coursework and has earned an approved industry credential completion of three years of jrotc work is consistent with current regulatory guidelines that recognize three years of JROTC for promotion purposes in the Armed Forces and completion of the JROTC leadership and employability skills assessment credentialing exam is highly encouraged by national JROTC leaders though this proposal does offer flexibility in the credentialing exam that can be used to meet the qualifying criteria are there any questions on

[00:14:15] either one of this these proposals are there any questions I do please yeah me I okay so you mentioned that unable to show growth due to the new test format how objective is that I did look through some of the June material and I looked up online and I see that the individual with Disabilities Education Act idea states that an IEP must include a description of how the child's progress towards meeting the

[00:14:53] annual goals will be measured and when periodic reports on the progress the child is making towards the annual goals will be provided and the every child maybe student succeeds act which governs the state assessment you know it maintains the no child let behind requirements that the state annually administer high-quality assessment in reading, language, arts, math, science that meet nationally recognized professional and technical standards. So I'm aware that in February

[00:15:28] 2019, the Virginia Superintendent of Public Instruction was notified by the U.S. Department of Education that Virginia did not meet requirements of the SEA as amended by ESSA for reading, language arts science and mathematics alternate assessments they told virginia to redesign or replace a vab to comply and then vdoe was given two years to submit evidence of an alternate assessment and it specifically stated that vdoe have procedures in place for participating rate

[00:16:00] calculations to ensure that each child is tested and now if the video accountability office is unable to provide a valid and reliable growth criteria there is difficulty in tracking and i mean i know that may be one data point but it's a significant data point for tracking it and encompasses not only the current year of standards of learning but all skills that should have been mastered from previous grade levels and parents want accountability that the children are on track

[00:16:37] to pursue post-secondary education and or employment and for three years now VDOE has known it needs to overhaul the assessment of our most vulnerable of children so when assessment formats change whether here or by any testing entities you know surely there are methodologies formulae for calculating in place to account for it i'm just not convinced that in reviewing all of this plus what i've read online that the june present interviewing the june presentation that the department has done enough and this is really just in regards to the first provision that you

[00:17:16] showed um i'm okay with the second provision but i am um would not uh go ahead with the first provision that's just my thought do you want to raise one okay good afternoon i'm shelly loving rider i'm the assistant superintendent for student assessment uh accountability and esea programs i wanted to try to address your question you were correct that uscd did tell us that we needed to

[00:17:50] replace our alternate assessment and the shelly i hate to do this in the worst possible way but i need to interrupt you for a second have a quick visit i think yes we do visit yeah you'll understand in a second so we're ready again my apologies shelly oh hello there we are how's everyone nice to see you you already hurt somebody well how are you i hope i hope everything's coming

[00:18:22] along nice to see you how are you nice to see how are you i will i'll share a few words they'll be they'll be short i appreciate you making time for my course yeah absolutely very excited thank you thank you thank you oh really oh you're kidding

[00:19:01] this is my wife suzanne hi how are you i'm dan i see you I'm glad you're being here. Yeah, absolutely. Appreciate your being here. How are you? It's just a lot. Great to see you. Where did they go? Nice to see you. And everybody's got good snacks. And everybody's got good snacks.

[00:19:17] Oh, beautiful. Why is that? Absolutely. Hi, how are you doing? It's good to see you. Yes, ma'am. Well, perfect. Well, thank you all for having me. Please sit there. Let me just say, ladies and gentlemen, obviously, we've been joined by the governor of Virginia.

[00:19:33] It is the board's honor and pleasure to welcome, I guess, the 74th governor of Virginia, his excellency. Glenn Youngkin and the first lady of Virginia, Suzanne Youngkin. Governor, thank you so much for spending the time with us. And if you have some remarks, we'd love to hear them. Very short. And I don't want to take up any of your very valuable time for the most important work that you're doing today. But I just appreciate an opportunity to come over and say hello and hello to those on the on the on the videogram today. So thank you. You know, one thing I am reminded is that

[00:20:06] George Jetson's birthday is right around the corner and we should all remind ourselves what we're doing today versus what we grew up with and to see you all on the video is just extraordinary and so so great to see you and thank you for making time I want to start with one clear message thank you thank you for the work that you all are doing this is an extraordinarily important board and you put in an extraordinary amount of time, it demands it. And I just want to thank all of you

[00:20:44] for providing the most important resource anybody has, which is their time and their talents. And so thank you for bringing them to the Commonwealth of Virginia service. Your mission is a mission that we all should lock arms around. And I know we do.

[00:21:02] And I'm just so moved by it. And it so embodies what we all know the future of Virginia must, in fact, provide, which is an excellent education for our children. But I think when you get specifically down into developing policies and providing leadership to improve student achievement right there, to improve student achievement and prepare students to succeed in post-secondary education and the workplace.

[00:21:32] And I think sometimes there might be an war in there where students choose to go work first before they head on to something else. I think the ability of Virginia's schools and our overall approach to education needs to embrace both of those ideas so that everyone in Virginia can become a fully engaged citizen.

[00:21:53] What a great mission. And it's one that I so deeply, deeply value. you. I had the great privilege over the course of last year campaigning, but even the greater privilege this year over the last seven months is serving 8.6 million Virginians. And I know you bring the exact same sense of a servant's minded

heart to this, of who we work for and its parents, its students, its teachers, its grandparents, its aunts, uncles. And this is our constituency

[00:22:28] who have dreams and aspirations, and through education in Virginia, they want to achieve them. We've accomplished a lot in the first seven months that I hope gives this group a great foundation. At the heart of it, the budget that I had the great privilege of signing in this past June was exactly the budget that I think collectively, in a bipartisan basis, we hoped for in education.

[00:22:56] the largest education budget in the history of Virginia, an extraordinary investment in Virginia's children's, a 10% raise for teachers. And I'll come back and talk about teachers in a minute. $1,000 bonus, a $1.25 billion capital foundation that supports well over $3 billion dollars of investments into our schools, into the facilities themselves. And side note, I had the great privilege of being in Mecklenburg County a couple weeks ago for the equivalent of a ribbon

[00:23:34] cutting of this extraordinary new integrated middle school and high school. And what happens when there's investment into the facilities brings with it a commitment that is felt by every constituent students parents teachers and so i'm so excited that we were able to really break what has been a norm for the state government to stand on the sidelines in this case to to provide this kind of unique funding into a much needed cause which is to invest in bricks and mortar for our

[00:24:08] children the historic investment into lab schools is something that we collectively will go on a journey together and this has generated such extraordinary excitement from all fronts from students to teachers to school boards to superintendents by the way universities community colleges centers for higher education businesses this is an all-in community partnership that's coming together around this concept this concept of simply innovating in our public schools

[00:24:46] as part of our public school system it is so exciting to get started on this together and to see where grassroots innovation takes us um just a great moment so i um i'm particularly excited about the work that you all are going to do with regards to overall curriculum i will tell you that we talk a lot about history and i want to be very clear i want us to teach all of our history in virginia the good and the bad we have an extraordinary history an extraordinary history that in fact is the history not just of the commonwealth of virginia but of the country

[00:25:25] and there's an opportunity for us to set a standard for what it means to educate our children in all of the lessons again i'll repeat the good and the bad but also the amazing progress that we've made in this country, and yet the times we failed. This is the moment for us to take a really, really serious look at how we are teaching this most important topic. Finally, and let me finish where I started. Thank you. This is a chance for Virginia across our entire education

[00:26:00] spectrum, early education. I am so encouraged by the great work going on in order to provide a foundational parent, public, private choice agenda into early education that is going to be absolutely the standard for the nation. And again, in our budget, there was great, great funding and support provided for this most important investment. K-12, we have a moment to again establish Virginia as the example of high expectations, the example of lifting the ceiling

[00:26:39] and the floor, the example for the nation about how to come together and provide our children the best opportunity for success, yes, in college and or a career. And then in higher education, and I am so encouraged by the great work going on across our higher education footprint. I had the opportunity to

meet again with the Council of Presidents this week, and I meet with them quarterly. And again, I'm encouraged by now this collaboration, which is coming together across disciplines, across K-12 and higher education at a moment where we've seen the penalties of the last

[00:27:18] two and a half years of this pandemic in absolute stereo for our children, where the learning loss is real. We're hearing about it as they head on to higher education and the work that this group can do in order to take big steps, in order to close that learning loss and make such a great connection as our students again pursue what is a lifelong learning experience in virginia so thank you it's no small task i know that um it's an extraordinary amount of work and the nine of you uh contribute such an extraordinary amount to it and so thank you for letting me drop by to say

[00:27:56] hello thank you for letting me interrupt your lunch although i don't see any food um but i know you've got a full agenda ahead of you and so i will step out of the way and let you get back to work but for those of you that are new um grace and everyone else thank you and for those of you that have been here for a while thank you for your service and i just look forward to continue to support everything that you do thank you thank you thank you thank you i'd love to do a group photo we're going to have to do it in front of the in front of the screen here

[00:28:33] i'd love the first lady the pictures are always better when she's in them We're working on rehab, we're making a move around.

[00:29:04] This is for the department right here.

[00:29:41] Awesome. Thank you all again. Thank you so much. I appreciate it.

[00:30:10] I think one of the things that we recognize is this just extraordinarily important partnership for the parents, teachers, and of course a student. roll out of the pandemic is just seeing the value of in-person education and other teachers and so we need to

[00:30:42] - Thanks for coming, we appreciate you. How can I get to touch my body? - Thank you. - Hi, how's everybody? - Thank you, you do. - And we'll get started. - We appreciate you. - How's everybody? - Thank you, we'll get started. - Okay, thank you all, thanks for coming and attending.

[00:30:58] - We appreciate you. How can I get to touch my body? - Yes sir. - We appreciate you. - Thank you. - Hi, how's everybody? - Thank you, you do. - Thank you, you do. - Thank you. Thank you, Governor.

[00:31:19] Thank you, Suzanne. Thank you.

[00:31:49] policy. All right. I guess we could start exactly mid-sentence when I interrupted you, Shelley, if that's okay. I'm sorry to have done that. I certainly understand. Make this train roll. So in terms of the new VAP assessment, you're absolutely correct. We did receive notification from USED in January of 2019 that the previously used VAP assessment was no longer permissible under ESSA and just as a reminder what we'd used before was a portfolio based assessment we are student work samples were collected they

[00:32:29] were scored locally and then we did audit part of the those collections because it was a portfolio it was based the scoring was based on a rubric so it didn't have a traditional scale score like a test would have so we did begin

[00:32:44] working very quickly to identify a new type of VAP assessment. We consulted across the country to see, you know, what we might be able to, where we might be able to partner with someone else.

And eventually we determined that we would partner with Oregon. So the assessment that we administered for the first time in 21-22 did include items that had also been used in Oregon.

[00:33:11] um we certainly value the the importance of the the scores for students with significant cognitive disabilities and we wanted to make sure that we had an assessment that would be appropriate for them we did administer the test for the first time this year obviously with the pandemic the development of a new assessment was was impacted by the the pandemic um just so you all are aware we did attempt to find a way to measure growth from the old assessment to the new, but because they are such different assessments, it was really hard to think about how you measure

[00:33:51] growth from a portfolio-based rubric score to a more traditionally, traditional scale score on the current test. We talked internally about it and also consulted with folks outside the agency and so what we came up with was the idea that if in fact um a school um a school's gap for students with disabilities was at the lowest level level three solely based on the scores for students on the vap that we would recalculate without those and reassign the level

[00:34:28] this is a temporary measure um and we will be able to measure growth from 2021-22 to 2022-23 because we will have the same assessment um but what we're proposing today is really a a way to transition from the old assessment to the new hopefully that answers at least some of your questions yeah i mean somewhat and you mentioned you consulted with folks outside of agency about the what were some of those would you be able to provide a list of or some of the

[00:35:04] names that you consulted with when you as far as the way of measuring growth yes and and i i just don't you know one of the speakers earlier said that you know students are the data points that really matter and for our most vulnerable of children i i'm still not convinced that because be shifted to a different paradigm a different format that we are not able to extrapolate or alter formula to be able to and again this is like a cumulative skill that's not only the

[00:35:38] skills that they learned one year and so i i'm i'm hesitant to to to look upon this provision favorably i just don't think i i can do that for our students with disabilities and again we do certainly value the contribution that those scores make. It's just a technical difficulty in trying to determine how to measure growth from two very different assessments.

[00:36:09] Okay. Are there any other questions? May I pose a question? No, there's Creasy first and then Dr. Siebert. Just one question. As you all looked at the opportunities for different assessments, were there any portfolio-based assessments that were acceptable, or is that no longer an acceptable means by which to assess our VAP students.

[00:36:33] USED's interpretation of ESSA is that a portfolio-based assessment solely is no longer acceptable. So you either have to combine something with it or find a different assessment. Could we go back to slide number five, which has got the example.

[00:36:52] So... Which one is it? Number five, the next one. This one? I just want to try to put it in layman's terms and make sure I'm understanding it. Shelly, thank you for the explanation. So in general here, the bar is being raised for students with disabilities by bringing, you know, an improved assessment on currently though to make look at the growth piece it's almost an apples to oranges comparison transparency is served because both the apples and the oranges are posted and you're saying that in terms of the provision of showing growth wait one year for that provision so that it can be oranges to oranges

[00:37:27] that's an excellent explanation I think like dr. Siebert I have some clarifying questions so this is one year it's only VAP students who are not making any changes to accountability for special education students overall correct okay and then finally with the stakeholder input uh to support his question what um uh what do we hear from parents so i know like there's a very active parent constituency uh in the state with regard to special ed like what did what did they say about this proposal as far as bap in

[00:38:02] general i think our parents have been fairly supportive of it we did do a great deal of outreach as we rolled this out because we knew it was such a different type of assessment i don't believe we've had any parent uh negative feedback on on this particular proposal did you have any parent positive feedback for the for the um and i'm not talking about the new assessment which i do understand and i've heard from parents who think that this is the right step forward this

[00:38:38] is a more rigorous way um but i think they are concerned that um that the growth the gap uh not be shoved under the carpet and have you have you really consulted with parents from local school divisions I'm not just talking with a local school division parents individual parents we have not done specific outreach to parents of course all of the board items are posted so that there's an opportunity for people to weigh in but but no we did not reach out to parents specifically about

[00:39:15] about this particular measure. - Okay, I think where we are is, we could go a couple different ways here. This is here on final review.

[00:39:33] Is there a harm, and I'm not suggesting we're gonna do this, if this did not get approved today? In other words, does delay hurt? Because again, with five new members, if people need more time, certainly would like to have that flexibility.

[00:39:52] And then second, sort of for the board, Is there, you know, the contemplation of a motion to approve these items in accordance with the superintendent's recommendation as set forth in the item? So, Mr. Gecker, as far as a delay, there would be an impact if we have a delay.

[00:40:12] We are scheduled to release accreditation in September, and so this would be part of the necessary calculations we would need for accreditation. Okay, and I think I heard, you know, some objection to the second measurement?

[00:40:29] the second phase of this, the college career and civic readiness piece. So we could break this into two motions, if that meets the board's pleasure to, because I have not really heard, you know, significant opposition to, you know, certainly the first prong of this. Mr. Gecker, it is the first prong that we need to calculate accreditation. The second one is not necessary for this year's calculation. Okay. So are there any motions from board members on this topic? Well, I mean,

[00:41:05] i would i would make motion if i may and i'm not sure of the procedures here that i would wish i would like to split this up because i i don't think parents are happy about this our special needs children so let me ask you a different way is there a motion to adopt in accordance with the superintendent's recommendation uh the first piece of this uh which is everything but the college career and civic readiness piece so moved thank you is there a second second all right All right, we have a motion and a second.

[00:41:43] So the motion is essentially to approve, Shelley, you want to put this in better words for me, the VAP piece? - Do you want to do it? - Sure. - I'm sorry, Amy, I should have gone to you. - That's okay. - You have the podium after all.

[00:41:59] - Yep, the motion would be to approve the special provision for the achievement gap for English and mathematics for the students with disabilities group that if the VAP assessments are the sole reason for a level three, they will be removed from the calculation to reestablish the performance level, but the actual rating that will be reported out is the level that does include the VAP scores.

[00:42:38] - Okay, Andy, can we ask questions at this point? - I'm concerned, I mean, this is pretty narrow. I don't think we love it and I don't think, don't hear from a lot of parents in virginia with kids with special needs that they feel like things are going great i think we can all agree to that but like i'm worried how much chaos we're going to cause around accreditation what our options are here uh dr ballast sort of a question in particular for you like what's gonna if we if we were to hit pause here or like what are we what downstream things that we unleash because this may be one that doesn't taste good but and we got to run an orderly system here it's um mr president and um mr rotherham that great question and of course i

[00:43:18] would like shelley to address that but in addition to the question as to what consequences this may hold i um i would also like shelley to just talk about maybe some different opportunities or some different options that were discussed beforehand that that might present different pathways if this weren't approved today just just to give a bigger picture so i think if if this were not approved then we would move forward with including the back scores in the calculations that that would be the the main change i don't think we know what impact that would have on any particular school's accreditation at this point because

[00:43:57] we've not yet done those calculations um as far as other options um uh amy may have to help me here but i mean we do you mean superintendent balo in terms of other options for looking at growth In addition to possible negative consequences, what opportunities would not approving this hold for us to just rethink and go down a different path?

[00:44:30] If you don't approve it again, we would move forward with including those scores in the accreditation calculations. It is a one-year only issue. We will have a way of measuring growth line 22. i think yeah the the the main impact or negative impact could be if you look at how the performance levels of each of those groups kind of roll up into the overall performance level once two of the

[00:45:03] student groups are a level three that indicator overall becomes a level three and when a school gets a level three in any of their indicators it is no longer accredited it's accredited with conditions and so this um i the impetus here is to not negatively impact schools because we are administering a new vap assessment this year that is an apples to oranges comparison where we can't

[00:45:41] show growth um again the information is reported out in the rate it's just the assignment of the performance level would be done without those failing vap scores so you mentioned if two sorry no please i'll i'll let you continue thanks dr man i you mentioned if two of the student groups are level three is there not what's the second group you're anticipating there might be level three it could be any of the other groups so

[00:46:18] if any of the other groups are if any of the other groups are a level three in addition to the students with disabilities group then that indicator itself will be a level three right so that's why with just this specific group group with just some of the times that there's some very low numbers in this category and a school perhaps had a high number of VAP students who failed, it would reflect in that

[00:46:51] level and then it kind of rolls up into the indicator and the school accreditation for that small number of students. Do you see any other group? I mean, I'm sure you've got all your numbers in by now.

Do you see any other group that falls in?

[00:47:10] - The numbers themselves for each of the indicators is specific to the school. So each school has their own, I guess, distribution of performance levels. So it just varies by school, whether each of those groups are level one, two, or three.

[00:47:28] - But I mean, have you seen any such case where there is a danger of the entire group falling in a level three because of two. And I understand student with disabilities being one. What's the other? - I would say that I have seen some reports when I was glancing through some of them that did have two indicators that were red and one of them was students with disabilities.

[00:47:56] - And what's the other one? - Oh, I don't recall what the other one was on this specific report. - Would you recommend that? - Pardon me? would still be kept but the the gap assessment for the student with disability is being recommended not to be so what would happen is if we took those failing BAP scores out of that student with disabilities and recalculated the rate if that rate ended up being in the level 2 range we would put level 2 but we'd still report out the the original rate with the scores in it so

[00:48:34] that does let parents know what the um the rate is of the school i mean that is still very transparent it's just that perhaps a very small number of students didn't have this kind of roll-up effect to the school accreditation i i just don't think i'm getting um i would like to know how many schools or divisions or have this danger of being having overall level three um before you know yeah i need more information more data i think the issue for us right now is we are

[00:49:11] in the middle of running accreditation so we yeah all right dr man you had a comment or question yes yes just really quickly just three really quick comments first i appreciated dr siebert's uh formation of sort of the essence of what we are being asked to do i think that was a very important sort of clarification to lift up secondly i certainly agree with um the comment that was made by mr rotherham about none of us are happy about sort of the the challenges that are evident

[00:49:47] as we think about children with special needs across the commonwealth um and and third you know when I look at the data on um vacancy rates by sort of area specialty we know that special education is up there it's it's the fourth highest special specialization across the commonwealth where we're struggling and so I do I do think that um we can all agree that those those those

[00:50:19] are facts and they're real and we need to make sure we're going at them I do see this as almost akin to the decisions we've made as we've had to adjust for COVID on a one-time basis and we've demanded or required that there be full transparency to schools so that they understand where we're making accommodations and I think the area of absence given the reality of COVID and quarantining and all of those things so i i just want to call those things forward uh in the spirit of

[00:50:55] recognizing the work that has been done uh under the uh extraordinary circumstances of the staff up to this point okay we have a motion before us in a second thank you dr man to uh approve the temporary alteration of the inclusion of the bap you know failing test records from the on the determination of performance level, et cetera.

[00:51:21] All those in favor of that motion, please signify by saying aye. - Aye. - Aye. - Any opposed? - Nay. - Okay, so that carries. And then on the second piece of this, we'd be looking for a motion to alter the measurement of the College Career and Civic Readiness Index by adding an additional qualifying criteria beginning in accreditation year 2023 to 2024.

[00:51:48] Is there a motion on that? Thank you, Ms. Creasy, is there a second? - Thank you, Mr. Rotherham. Is there any other discussion there? All those in favor of that motion signify by saying aye. - Aye. - Aye.

[00:52:04] - Any opposed? Thank you all very much. - Thank you. - All right, I am told that folks are getting hungry up here. I'm not sure I actually believe it, but I am told that. So we're gonna take the quick lunch break. We'll be back in 25 minutes, 20 minutes at call at 1:35.

[01:18:00] We're going to try to move along here, and not yet, Dr. Alvin, I'm sorry. We're accommodating schedules today, so I'm sorry about all the switches.

[01:18:18] All right. We are honored again to have with us the Secretary of Education, Secretary Gadara. Welcome. We're going to move on to items H and I, and with her, I guess, is Deputy Secretary of Education, Mackenzie Snow. I don't know who's doing what but absolutely anywhere you'd like this is your building mr. mr. president I also want to introduce another member of the secretary staff Maddie who's bringing around handouts right now right thank

[01:18:51] you she's policy I don't not sure your mic is on right now mr. president you hear me no this is better much better thank you I'm sorry about that that's - That's okay, no.

[01:19:14] Mr. President, members of the board, it is a delight to be with you today. It's so nice to see the new member and I'm sorry, I'm waving to those of you on the screen too. It's wonderful to see you virtually. It's good to know the governor knows when George Jetson's birthday is, so we'll talk about that too.

[01:19:30] Thank you. This is a day that we're very excited to be here to talk about. This conversation around innovation lab schools is one that we started on the first week of the administration. And as you know, it is a priority of the governor's and of ours and the Secretary of Education to really focus on how do we bring innovation and focus on partnership and on providing many options to ensure that we're preparing every single Virginia learner for success in life.

[01:20:03] And as you heard during the public comment, examples and discussions from local stakeholders who believe deeply in this concept bringing this innovation through a commitment to partnership and a commitment to seeing every child where they are and helping them to get where they need to go and realizing that our one-size-fits-all system is not serving all kids uh you know the superintendent will be putting out sol scores tomorrow and what those numbers are going to show us is what we already know is that our system is not serving all kids well and that we need to think innovatively about how do we make sure that we provide alternative ways to make sure that all of our kids are achieving at high levels and are

[01:20:39] are prepared for life, and that they also understand the various pathways to get them prepared for life. And so that's the heart and soul of what these lab schools are about. So I'm going to just start with a couple things, and I'm glad Mackenzie's going to drive for me on slides, of what we want to do with you today. One, we just want to provide an update of where we are in the process. We're excited to provide that update. There's been a lot of thinking that's been going on in the last seven months, and we're thrilled today to provide for you, we hope for not just presentation and conversation, but approval, the planning grant guidelines and we're hoping that those are things that that you all have comments on but we can also improve so we can start this process immediately of

[01:21:15] having the excitement around lab schools actually turn into planning grants so that our our excited stakeholders can start working towards applying for these we also want to provide a first review of the startup and the per pupil operating fund guidelines and we're eager to get your feedback on those as well to make sure that we can continue moving the process along but I first First, I just want to start with a couple of what are lab schools and why do they matter?

[01:21:39] I am not going to read slides to you. They're in there for the public piece. But what I want to just highlight on here is, you know, lab schools have been around for a long time. And we have lots of examples you've been reading about in the paper of many of our schools which have had lab schools. For example, Hampton University and their pre-K lab schools that they had at their school of education to ensure that they were using best practices to ensure that they were preparing children in the Hampton Roads areas for success in school and kindergarten readiness.

[01:22:05] We also know that some of the nation's best schools today started as lab schools, Horace Mann in New York City. Right? So lab schools have just been part of our ecosystem in education. And yet we don't have any right now here in Virginia. We had statutory language that was put into place in 2010 and established and it gives us the framework that we're using today to talk about this expansion of lab schools and talking about it.

[01:22:28] But we have none of them. argue the reason we don't have them is because we never put into place incentives for people to do the extra work that it takes to start these schools right of being in partnership of thinking about outside the box of how do we do differently how do we meet families and kids where they are and we also didn't provide dollars to do this right there was a fund that was set up but no money was ever appropriated by the general assembly to do so and what we're excited to dive into today is tell you what's different this time and why are we poised to have these lab schools be a success not just for the commonwealth but most importantly to reach those goals of serving children especially those that have been traditionally underserved in virginia and

[01:23:08] making sure that we're bringing innovation partnership and better pathways to better success to all of our students in the commonwealth um so the why right that is the why how do we embrace and again these words that are that are highlighted here innovation high standards collaboration and alternative and promoting innovative instruction and thinking differently about how do we meet people we've tried to build these guidelines that you have in your materials in a way that allows these schools to be built so that they are responsive to local needs that they are responsive to the community needs and what you heard from Superintendent Nichols today was exactly that of how is he working in partnership with higher

[01:23:46] education and with businesses like Microsoft to make sure that they are meeting the unique economic needs of their region and the needs of their students and making sure that they're getting the results and what you'll hear from us the entire morning not morning the couple minutes that we have with you is I promise we won't stay here till tomorrow morning is is a commitment to doing things differently and making sure that this is that these are schools that are going to focus on increasing student achievement increasing long-term outcomes and having a long-term impact this is not a short-term effort this is one that we're looking at how do we build these schools to have a lasting long-term sustainable impact on this um and this bottom line is as our as our scores will show

[01:24:26] tomorrow in our sol release one size fits all approach to education doesn't work anyone who has more than one child living in their home and watching them go through school know that kids need different ways to excel and to thrive and that's at the heart and soul of what these lab schools are about is helping to provide lots of different ways for our children to succeed but Holding firm the commitment to high standards high expectations and getting results and that's our commitment So I'm going to turn it over to McKenzie to go through some of the specifics and I'll be jumping in at different times But I just want to thank you so much for putting this on the agenda And we're excited to get started and the people of Virginia are excited to get started with having more innovation in our public education system

[01:25:04] So thank you Secretary Goddard for that amazing framing so I'm going to dive a little bit more into the details of the statutory requirements of a lab school As you all know lab schools are tuition-free public non-sectarian and non-religious schools that are approved by the State Board of Education and upon approval from the State Board of Education and Approved lab school creates a governing board or body referenced in this document that executes the contract with the State Board of Education We do encourage that those governing boards that are established have strong

[01:25:38] Representation and fair representation of all the partners included in the lab school including as you heard this morning local school divisions Community partners and employers and then that contract that we referenced is extremely important Especially because of the academic and operational performance Expectations that are included in it and those are the benchmarks or the metrics by which the lab school will be judged by the State Board of Education And then finally lab schools are of course subject to all state and federal laws Which includes the standards of quality the standards of learning and the standards of accreditation

[01:26:13] There's one exception here a collaborative partnership, which is a partnership between a lab school and a local school division results in an educational program The lab school being an educational program of that local school division for the purposes of standards of accreditation So the lab school that is the result of a collaborative partnership is meeting that metric Am I is there back feed? Sorry about that is meeting that metric through that local school division And then we have some exciting general assembly updates front from this past session

[01:26:49] As you know, the general assembly included a 100 million dollar disbursement into the college partnership Laboratory school fund during the 2022 session It's important to know that this fund has existed since the initial code language in 2010 but prior to 2022 there has not been an appropriation in the fund and the fund has three distinct set-asides there's five million for planning grants 20 million for startup grants and then the balance which is at minimum 75 million goes to support the per pupil operating grants for those

[01:27:25] approved and launched lab schools and then secondly and importantly the Appropriation Act amended at the statutory definition of a lab school so previously a lab school had to be a public or private institution of higher education with an educator prep program this enactment clause actually removed the requirement to have an a board approved educator preparation program and expanded the eligible entities to include community colleges and higher education centers to ensure equity and access to lab schools across the

[01:27:59] Commonwealth so I'll take it back for a second I want to make sure that we address some of the concerns that came up in the public comment about it's is there an issue right now with the appropriation

and using the new the newly enlarged eligible higher education institutions that can apply for a lab school and receive dollars we have worked deeply to make sure that this issue has been cleared and that there is not an issue here we have worked not only with a great team here at the Department of Education Kent Dickey Leslie Sale and the rest of Superintendent Baylor's team to make sure that this has worked,

[01:28:35] but we've also made sure we've had expert guidance from the Department of Planning and Budget, the AG's office, and also you have in your packet a letter of clarification from Chairman Barry Knight, reinforcing that the intent of the conversation and the debate that happened, and as you heard from Delegate Davis during the public comment period, that the intent of bipartisan support was to ensure that not only we expanded the eligible higher education institutions, which could sponsor and launch a lab school, but also to receive funding from that $100 million.

[01:29:06] So I just wanted to make sure and highlight that. As Delegate Davis said, if there are technical issues that come up that we need to deal with, we will deal with them. We will commit to doing that. But at this moment, all recommendations from every expert that we have talked to says to continue to move forward and to keep this process going so we can meet the demand that exists out there and that we can build these schools that we know are going to change kids' lives.

[01:29:29] Thank you. And then next up we have the timeline. And I know this is a very busy slide, but we wanted to ensure that you had all the printed information and could map this out alongside us. So we start our timeline with today, August 17th. The board is considering the planning grant guidelines and providing a first review of the startup and per pupil grant guidelines.

[01:29:51] And then the department intends to quickly thereafter in late August of this year, publish those planning grant application form, the planning grant application form that will very closely aligned to the board approved guidelines. And the department will begin accepting and reviewing those planning submissions on a rolling basis.

[01:30:11] And it's important to note that during this period, the board will also be working to convene the committee on the college partnership laboratory schools or we'll call it the standing committee, because we expect to receive applications in short order.

[01:30:26] And then in early September of 2022, the application for the approval of a lab school, so the approval to launch a lab school, will be updated just to reflect those statutory requirements. We articulated a couple slides back. And recall that this application form is very, very similar to that the board approved in july of 2012 just with those technical and statutory updates so that will not require board approval or board action um and then we hope that the board and the standing committee of the board will begin accepting and reviewing those applications for approval to launch a lab

[01:31:04] school in that time frame and then on the second row you'll see that in the next board meeting in in September, we hope to see the board provide final review of the startup and per pupil grant guidelines, and similar to the planning grant, we plan to launch that corresponding form shortly thereafter and begin accepting and reviewing those submissions for startup and per pupil grants on a rolling basis.

[01:31:33] It's important to note here that only after a lab school receives approval from the state board to launch, may they apply for and receive those startup and per pupil grant funds.

[01:31:48] And then in winter of 2022, we expect that the standing committee and the department will be reviewing those applications for approval to launch a lab school and providing that department first review and that standing committee recommendation. And then also in winter of 2022, that the board will be reviewing those applications for approval.

[01:32:08] And the board's decision there is of course final. And then in spring of 2023, beginning as early as February when teacher recruitment really starts, we expect those lab schools that hope to launch in 23, 24 to begin recruiting teachers, to begin recruiting students.

[01:32:25] And then we expect a number of lab schools to be launching in 23, 24. And then just one other note on the slide, we are bringing before you the guidelines. And I've articulated a couple of times the application form will be based closely on those guidelines but the board is considering delegating that authority to review those funding applications score those funding applications based on the articulated rubric to the department of education we'll continue and dive in a bit more

[01:33:01] into the planning grant guidelines which is our first step in that timeline and your agenda item age yes dr mann can you hear us yes i can hear i mean i've been i've been through the board book theory i there was a lot to go through and i definitely went through it i just couldn't find it it seems like my link i was accessing had um the the mon the guidelines document twice it was

[01:33:38] it's at least in mind but i don't want to distract i can certainly get a copy on follow-up and i think um someone will work to send you a copy of that to your email if that's easier to access okay thank you thank you um so then diving a bit into the content of the planning grant guidelines which you all have the opportunity uh to to review uh just to to bring front of mind again these are one-time grants that we do not expect to exceed 12 months and we expect those grants to be up to 200 000 with the discretion to consider on a case-by-case basis an amount

[01:34:17] exceeding that in accordance with available funds. And then we've just pulled a couple of those core application required components. There's basic things like your applicant, your partners, assurances to abide by state and federal law, your budget. But importantly, it also includes the school governance structure, facilities, mission and pedagogy, assessment, the student population you hope to serve, your instructional model with a focus on those outcomes that the secretary articulated, proficiency, college and career readiness long-term outcomes your description of your plan for involvement of teachers parents

[01:34:53] community organizations and employers and how you plan to secure partners both of those last two components really drive at the sustainability of the lab school idea that you are developing and this was an important to pull this is directly out of your proposed planning grant guidelines but we have here the timeline and benchmarks and deliverables for each quarter of the planning grant so in the first quarter you're articulating your proposed deliverables in the second quarter you are providing a progress report report to ensure that you can obtain that second installment

[01:35:33] of the award importantly in the third quarter you are expected to have submitted a application for approval of a lab school to the state board of education and in that fourth quarter we expect Many will have attained approval by the state board of education to launch a lab school and again we articulate quarters Because some have expressed interest in six-month planning grant applications up to a year so important to pull out and then finally I think this was a particular point of

[01:36:07] Confusion related to the department's evaluation of submissions the department intends to do so based on a weighted rubric and and using peer reviewers scoring those applicants on the weighted rubric, the language for those factors, those rubric factors is directly in the planning grant guidelines and they are the five factors in front of you.

[01:36:30] You also, I believe, have a handout that proposes a minor line edit to replace a confusing phrase with just using these components in the rubric on page three of the guidelines in the agenda item age. if you could please consider that clarifying edit to to make exponentially clear that these are the rubric factors we would recommend that the board uh consider approval of the guidelines with that edit and i now get to spend some time on my favorite slide on this entire deck so the reason

[01:37:07] we're asking you to act on this today is what this slide shows is incredible interest across the commonwealth on building these schools and people are ready to go and they keep thinking they've missed the deadline that they got announced about that so we would love to be able to say it's time it's time that you can apply for these what this shows you is the embodiment of what we want our lab school map to look like long term what you see here is that we have over um over 39 higher education institutions across the commonwealth in every superintendent's region which you know is in our guidelines that we will not put one a second one in any region until there is one in

[01:37:46] every single region because we are serious about that regional diversity we are serious about making sure that these schools of innovation are targeting students who have traditionally been underserved that the system has not served as well and making sure that we're doing that in every single region and that's critical and this is about improving student achievement and what we're seeing from this is that our higher education institutions our public and private four years our community colleges, our higher ed centers are ready to go. And I just want to give you a couple examples of what I'm seeing as I'm going across the Commonwealth and just a flavor and a sense of the energy and excitement that's out there. I was in Lynchburg last week, and every one

[01:38:24] of the higher education institutions in the city of Lynchburg is partnering together to create a lab school. They have put together a team, including with community foundations, with employers, with nonprofit providers, to work together to say, how do we build a school. They have two ideas. They may actually apply for two lab schools. One, they want to focus on literacy. And another one, the school division is really interested in working with their middle schools, right? Two really interesting, exciting ideas. And they're going to work together to figure out what best serves the students and the families of Lynchburg. And I just want to say that that's this moment of higher education, community partners, employers,

[01:39:00] and our K-12 system working together to figure out how to best serve students who lots of times have not been served and have not been getting we've not been getting the results they deserve and need to have another example you heard from superintendent Paul Nichols today from Mecklenburg we were down there three months ago and he said we want to be a lab school and what he's building there in terms of career academies and ensuring that every single one of his students starting in seventh grade will be exposed to careers and will leave not only with a degree a k-12 degree but also an associate's degree or dual enrollment credits or opportunities to work hands-on and have internships in community he wants to be a lab school because the partnerships he's already built with the higher

[01:39:39] education system he wants to just leverage those and make sure that they are serving his students well and finally you got to hear from um from kumi gornson who heads up code rva which is just one of our treasures of innovation in virginia the result that she is getting serving students from 15 neighboring school divisions is incredible and it is this heart and soul that to me is the heart and and so what we're trying to do is to bring that innovation and those results and bring them to every corner of the commonwealth and with the commitment that kumi has made and chris doby's made with code rva with code va is to make sure that we have one of those schools in every single

[01:40:15] one of our divisions and what's also inspiring is that the private sector has stepped up chris mentioned this early in his public comments but google has committed 250 000 to make sure that this gets launched amazon has committed to not just to the commute the computer science work but they have said that these lab schools are a core part of their workforce development investments in the commonwealth of virginia there is a commitment from lego that i encourage you to look at we'll send you the link to the video made by the director of education of lego of saying we want to talk about how we can be a part of changing learning and achievement in the commonwealth as you know they're one of our latest companies to join the commonwealth and

[01:40:50] they're coming in not just to get employees but to make sure they're building the the employees the future um and we also have microsoft that is also committed to working with our computer science piece and already doing incredible work down in mecklenburg so we have these incredible private sector partners that want to work and they want to make sure that they are that we're all building together the education system that serves all students and prepares all learners for success in life um and i just think this picture is worth a thousand words so i will stop saying words and move on but we're happy to answer any questions about this but we're really excited about how people have responded um and this is just the beginning of what we're seeing everywhere we go

[01:41:26] people are like i'm not on the map but i want to get on the map so um thanks for helping us to meet that demand that's growing out there and then i'll find my final thing i'll say is we're the we're going to start as soon as you all give the blessing that we can start and we can get these planning guidelines and the application out there for the planning grants we are going to do everything possible to make sure that there is no one in the commonwealth does not know how they can be involved in a lab school. So we are going to be working in partnership with all of our education associations, the constituency organizations, the business community, all the higher ed organizations, community college system, and SHEV to make sure that we do a series of webinars where we can

[01:42:03] provide the opportunities and walk people through how they can be part, how their members can be part of this culture of innovation that we're going to be building together. So that's our next step. As soon as you all give us the thumbs up, we will be out there talking about this, advertising it, helping people understand how they can be engaged and involved and then we think that these numbers will grow even bigger and we'll have even a stronger network of innovative schools um just happening across the commonwealth um so to go there i would love a couple if we can pause for some conversation on this planning piece and one is we have two things we particularly want to hear your feedback on but also we are happy to answer any questions and leslie and i can't are

[01:42:41] here as well to answer the really hard questions um we'll do the easy ones uh but we'd love to hear your um any advice you have for us about how do we could make sure that we get the outreach out across the commonwealth and so that we're truly listening to people and making sure that there's no one

that doesn't understand how they can be involved in this and second of all as mckenzie explained in the process the standing committee that will be established by the board it plays a critical role in ensuring that we are having a process that ensures that there are quality applications and that we are spending the money of the the people's money uh well and that we're

[01:43:17] investing in plans, and then eventually into schools that are built for sustainable and lasting and public and positive change and impact. And so we would love to get your recommendations about people and the types of people, and if you have specific names as well, that you think we should consider putting on that committee as well. So I'm going to pause speaking at you and just would love any feedback, any questions you have, and any specific responses those two questions. Thank you Madam Secretary and Mackenzie just a couple quick questions when you had your map up there are you planning on 25 to 39

[01:43:54] planning grants going out to the tune of a couple hundred thousand each or what how many do you think is your anticipation? So we have I think we have enough that we can do 25 planning grants so we're also going to do a little matchmaking when people come up and they're in the same neighborhood we're going to encourage them to partner together too so that we want it gets a better result. And two, we think these planning grants, there's going to be a huge demand for them. And so we want to be able to fund as many as possible, but at the same time, we're also going to be strategic and encouraging people to work together.

[01:44:28] And when the planning grants come in, just in terms of the lessons learned or just assimilating all of the data and the input and the innovation and the ideas that are coming in, are you going to try to serve as a clearinghouse to maybe share the lessons learned or the best practices So part of this, as I think the superintendent has shared before, is that she has started a new office here at the department that is all about innovation.

[01:44:57] And so our whole goal is how do we start, and there's lots of innovation going on in different places. There are magnet schools, there are pieces, but what we've heard is that they're episodic, there's no network, there's no learning from each other. And so our commitment, and we're doubling down by doing the lab school, but it's also identifying anything that's starting to um get different results and doing things in a different way that we start seeing and cataloging innovation and innovative ideas we start learning from it and we start sharing it and we start growing it and so one of the ideas that we have is how do we have an annual conference where we bring together folks who want to learn from this and say what do we know is working how do we do more of that and we think that there's an appetite and a hunger for doing

[01:45:36] more of this on learning from this so this is a core part of this of how do we incent build and and grow a culture of innovation. That's not just innovation for innovation's sake and doing something differently, but innovation for better results and for better long-term outcomes.

[01:45:52] - I do have some questions. Could you please elaborate on the targeted student population? - Sure, I'm happy to. So we specifically referenced the statutory definition of at-risk students, but the proposed guidelines in front of you expand upon that to include those students who are most affected by COVID-related learning loss And those students who are served in schools identified through either federal or state accountability.

[01:46:17] So for state denied accreditation or accredited with conditions and for federal accountability, those CSI, TSI and ATS schools. Another question is that you mentioned there is on the slide, there is a governing body for an approved school.

[01:46:35] What would the composition of a governing body look like and what is it really? So the approved applicant, meaning the eligible post-secondary entity, is required to establish a governing body. And that is the entity that actually enters a contract with the State Board of Education.

[01:46:55] The governing body and their members are selected by that applicant, that approved applicant. But we encourage and strongly encourage there to be representation of all the partners and all of the community members being served by the prospective lab school to be represented on that governing board or body.

[01:47:16] - One third question. When you mentioned a few of the high-tech companies, immediately I started talking, thinking about what kind of data collection might there be? Would these private, these high-tech companies have access to?

[01:47:31] Would they have, you know, there's always a concern about our children's being data mined and all of that. So what kind of data would these companies have access to? Would they have access to any? - So that is incorporated in that broader statement that the lab schools must comply with all federal and state requirements in code and regulation.

[01:47:56] So FERPA at the federal level, state student data privacy requirements. So the student data privacy requirements that district public schools are subject to, lab schools would also be subject to. But you know that data mining is happening in our public school systems.

[01:48:13] My children went to school where they were data mined, where children are being surveyed and being data mined by their multimillion-dollar contracts by the local school boards employing these data mining companies. So that's a little of concern to me.

[01:48:30] So I just took something to keep in mind, that's all. President Gecker. Yes. Yes, thank you so much, Secretary Federa. It's clear there's a lot of passion, and it's certainly important that we be focused on doing all we can to make things better for children, for sure, through this initiative.

[01:48:56] I was curious about to what extent is the, I had a chance to look back at the 2011 application tied to the lab school, when it was first legislated and authorized. And I'm just kind of curious that the guidelines are pretty broad, um, as they are articulated.

[01:49:15] But when you, when you look back at the application that, that undergirds, um, that previous legislation, it's pretty, it's pretty detailed in terms of what the expectations are for, uh, schools that are interested in this path.

[01:49:30] And I know in the, in the materials, it noted that some of that information would be leveraged. So I am curious, because what we see before is quite broad, how much of that will be leveraged. And then secondly, and I do think you spoke to this, with the intent and spirit of this really being about building bridges to improve education beyond the students that will be served in these schools, I do wonder to what extent there is information being brought to bear where that has actually been done well in other places and how that is going to show up

[01:50:09] in the structure or the guidelines or the office that the secretary or uh superintendent balo has referenced is being established because that's really where you know the rubber meets the road if these things become hothouses for particular communities and there truly isn't a way to understand how we get to bringing those ideas to light in other places where the context is similar because certainly contextual

factors matter a lot when you're trying to understand outcomes. So those are my two quick questions. Thank you. I'll take the last one and then I'll

[01:50:48] turn it. So I'll do the last one in front. We absolutely commit to making sure that we are learning the whole process, that we all learn together and how we make sure that we do create this um innovation and they're going to be things that don't work right and we're going to learn as much from the things that we find out that don't work as we do that that do and there's also a focus on evidence-based approaches that you'll see in the guidelines so absolutely share your commitment to how do we make sure that we are learning from this and that um that this is something that we continue to grow and that the bottom line is it's serving students work that well and better and i'll turn it to mckenzie for the hard questions about the application and thank you - Thank you for those great questions, Dr. Mann.

[01:51:25] I think I'd just point you again to the rubric, the weighted rubric factors and targeted student population alongside relevant research and ensuring innovative models are grounded in evidence-based practices as a specific requirement and criterion by which the applications will be reviewed.

[01:51:45] And then thank you for the opportunity to clarify the different applications. So we're actually talking about three applications in this entire timeline process. What's before you now is the application for planning grant funds. What you referenced is the application for board approval to launch a new lab school.

[01:52:05] And as we articulated in the discussion of the timeline, we believe that that application will stay very substantially similar with the exception of updates to the statutory changes that we articulated earlier in the presentation, especially to the eligible entities.

[01:52:22] So in looking at that application, that will be a very similar application to what lab schools are responding to to get approval. But we are considering an earlier step in that process, which is the planning grant that gets them in a position to submit a competitive and high quality application for approval using the form you referenced.

[01:52:42] - Thank you for that clarification. - Thank you. - Anybody else? - Yeah, Mr. President, this is really exciting. First of all, I mean, to see the energy and to see the slide with like all the interest. we saw this morning, the code VA stuff and all the interest there. It's fantastic to see that it's unleashing energy like that. I suspect I'm not telling you anything you don't already know.

[01:53:02] This is a really fast timeline. It can be done, but this is an ambitious timeline to open schools. So with the names, the reviewers and so forth, how wide of a net do we want to cast? Because obviously there's lots of lessons nationally. There's lots of places where they have really high quality authorizers and a lot of expertise. And I think people are excited to see Virginia moving this way. So I think there's a lot of people would be willing to, you know, throw some sweat equity into helping us. Like when you want names of potential reviewers, how wide of a net do you want us to cast? I'd like to get the best people possible. You know, of course, we want to make sure we get Virginians on here because these are Virginia's kids. But I think also if we can

[01:53:40] also thread that needle and get Virginians who are also national experts, that would be ideal. But I also would ask the board to consider folks who don't live in Virginia who are willing to help us build the best in class system of innovation would be great too. But that's up to you all to decide what who you want to put on that and just a quick distinction so the Standing Committee members are selected by the

Board of Education I think we look to pull from that for the peer reviewers but the peer reviewers will be convened by the VDOE or to ensure that we are responding expeditiously to the applications so do we submit the by the recommended recommend the people to you

[01:54:17] to send send them on to you I think you would recommend proposed members of the standing committee to the president and then to the superintendent for proposed peer reviewers maybe just a little clarity on the standing committee in terms of how long will it be standing how many members are you looking for what's the workload so as we kind of think of some folks that could do it look so I think I think we hope to have both representation of this the state school board excuse me State Board of Education on the standing committee as

[01:54:52] well as experts across the Commonwealth and across the nation. They will be doing a significant amount of the work to review and detail those applications for approval and making a recommendation to the full board for approval or denial. So it is a highly important and significant task.

[01:55:12] In terms of timeline, as I understand this, the request is to wait first review and do the planning grant guidelines today. It does not seem that the lab school committee needs to be formed today because it's going to be at least six, probably a year out before we have applications to review. Is that accurate? I'm not looking to hold you up, but perhaps we could put on our next agenda the formation of a standing committee, which is we don't have today, and then we can discuss how big, who comprises it, but pushing that out a month doesn't hurt you all at all, right?

[01:55:51] So I think that works for the timeline, but we would encourage the board to act expeditiously because we know of many who will plan quickly and submit quickly. If they get it done within 30, I'll be pretty impressed, particularly since the operational guidelines won't be done until, I mean, you're not asking for those today, and so we're at least 30 days out from those. So in terms of steps, approval of the planning grant guidelines today, next month we can talk about the board formally forming the lab school committee, and then take once we understand what that looks like, how many, what the composition ought to be,

[01:56:30] we can take recommendations for who ought to be on it, and then we push on from there. And as I said, that does not seem to be to impact negatively your timeline at all. That's great. Thank you, sir okay mr president yes ma'am i'm sorry if when you're done i have i'm done i will always yield to you thank you um uh secretary godera and so thank you so much for your uh presentation i have two questions one is simply we those of us on the virtual participants are the virtual participants

[01:57:07] uh can't see your screen we can some of us anyway to see the presentation that was filed in advance But one thing I couldn't see is what is your – there's a friendly amendment language you're asking us to adopt to the guidelines. Am I right?

[01:57:22] Can you fill that out for us? On page three, Ann, just going back on the history on this, there was a concern about just a complete naked delegation of everything to the department. And it was suggested by our council that we establish a framework by which the department would make the decisions they're going to be asked to make under the delegation we're doing. The original document just said we're delegating. The revised document essentially takes out the idea that the department designs the rubric and still

[01:57:57] includes the same five factors. To date, or at least to this point, although it's referred to as a weighted rubric, there is no weighting associated with it at this point. I'm hopeful that the secretary or the deputy secretary will tell us what the anticipated weighting is gonna be at the five factors.

[01:58:15] - I'm happy to do that. And just a point of clarification on our intent. I think that that was an issue in drafting. It was never the intent of the department or the secretariat to not have the board dictate the factors for the weight of the rubric.

[01:58:31] - We were not offended. - Just to clarify, so. - Just following the rules. - But also, if I may, my question is just to understand what sentence is being amended and how, or do we know that yet? Yes. They're taking the language designed by the department that is aligned to the application components and emphasizes that language is being struck so that the full sentence or the portion of the sentence reads, according to a weighted rubric, using the following factors. So basically they took out the idea that the department did it all and essentially established this document

[01:59:05] as providing the department with the guidelines or the guardrails around which to design the rubric. Thank you. Thank you. And then I didn't mean to cut you off this note. If you had something else to add, or I can go to my next question, whichever.

[01:59:22] No, just to finish answering your question about the weighting. So we have been working through this. We have a proposed weight of 30 points for the targeted student population and relevant research, 20 for the clarity of program description, goal, and timeline that talks about the capacity, 20 points for sustainability and institutional commitment.

[01:59:43] 15 points for collaboration with school divisions, community-based organizations, employers, teachers, and parents, and then 15 for regional and applicant diversity to support both new applicants in at least one lab school in each of the superintendent's regions, as articulated by Secretary Gadara.

[02:00:02] Okay. I'm certainly comfortable with those waitings. Thank you for providing. Anne, you had a second question? Yes. Thank you. thank you all first of all for bringing these exciting guidelines to us for consideration today for this exciting project. I have as you know we have heard from the Division of Legislative Services and the Finance Committee raising questions about the legislative intent of the budget language as to whether or

[02:00:42] not private universities and community colleges are eligible for these planning grants and the other lab school grants. I am a lawyer and therefore smart enough not to be my own lawyer and I'm hoping we're going to get legal advice on that question from our council but I guess my question to you pending that legal advice is has the Department of Planning and Budget and the planning of the staff of the uh senate finance committee and house appropriations committee have they met and

[02:01:20] tried to work out their differing understandings of this budget language and if not would that be a fruitful thing for them to do with or without lawyers their respective lawyers in the room it's been my experience that those folks work pretty well together and understand these budget documents better than any of the rest of us ever will and if they haven't had that opportunity yet is that a fruitful thing that we should try to figure out how we can keep things moving forward without presuming an answer on that dispute until they have an opportunity to try to work it out.

[02:01:57] In other words, I don't have a dog in this fight. I don't want to be the judge of it. I want to have the folks who know better than me, budget people and lawyers, figure it out. How can we have a process

make that work. All right. With regard to the process, Sam, I'll let Secretary Gadara answer that. With regard to the legal issue before the board, as you know, we as a board are not really equipped to resolve issues like that, and we rely very heavily on advice of counsel. Anticipating this issue would arise today, I have consulted with our counsel and am persuaded that the broader

[02:02:32] definition incorporated in the document before us is the correct position. However, that being said, if anybody else subsequent to adoption or whatever we end up doing with these guidelines wants to challenge it that's in a venue other than here but for the board's purposes the legal advice we have received is that the broader language you know broader availability of the grant is the correct reading so the legal counsel you have received is that the broader language that includes private universities and community colleges is the appropriate uh reading of the budget bill

[02:03:10] that's very helpful to understand and and there's one more question before i defer back to secretary gadara but to you then mr president there i had a second legal question about the document and that is whether or not we the board have authority to uh delegate do we have the uh is it legal for us to defer to delegate our authority over these grants to the department as these guidelines proposed and have you gotten advice on that legal question as well

[02:03:44] yes of course we anticipated this one also uh and the answer seems to be uh and the reason for the change in the document is the sort of naked delegation was probably not the best course of action although potentially not unlawful however the delegation with the direction that is with the guidelines set out and frankly when the motion's made i hope we incorporate the of rubric waiting that was just discussed.

[02:04:12] A delegation with clear direction is apparently acceptable to the AG's office. - Okay, thank you. So that resolves my legal, my understanding of the legal questions. And so my back to Secretary Gadara had the DTP folks and the Senate finance and House approach people had a chance to meet and is there any reason that, would it be helpful to give them an opportunity to try to resolve this or is that unnecessary or a problem at this point?

[02:04:41] - Thank you for the question. So they have, we have met with them all independently. I don't know if they have met together. All together we can go back and check on that and see, but I think they have all met independently. They have all given us the feedback of keep moving forward with this. And as you heard Delegate Davis say today, you know, Chairman Knight's letter says, this is the intent, there was bipartisan support for this.

[02:05:03] And we defer to their judgment on that and on that. But at the same time, as both the president has said here today and also Delegate Davis, if there are technical fixes that need to be made, we are committed to making sure we do everything right on this. So. And just one additional point. Thank you. These guidelines were developed in collaboration with DPB and with OAG. So I think that was mentioned earlier, but just to, again, articulate. Okay. So I think that covers everybody's questions for now. I'd be happy to entertain a motion to adopt the guidelines with the weightings as set forth by the Deputy Thank you, Secretary.

[02:05:41] Is there such a motion? Thank you. Mr. Trecy. Is there a second? Thank you, Mr. Hansen. Any other discussion? Seeing none, all in favor signify by... Oh, I'm sorry, Alan. No, I was just... One of the questions the secretary asked, Mr. President, if I may, was about getting the word out. I think the word is out.

[02:05:57] There's considerable excitement already existing in the field and throughout the regions. I think part of that was because the legislative process, you know, actually worked commendably well and that there was a lot of efforts to make sure that local school boards were still were still at the table and engaged and having authority over their areas so in terms of representation i would just encourage you all to again kudos for keeping the regional representation going i would also just kind of look forward to uh how you know how the virginia school association and or other local boards could be involved in the process but i i think the word is out and so i think there will be an abundance of applications and uh this is this is very exciting

[02:06:33] all right uh motion and a second uh all in favor signify by saying aye aye aye any opposed don't see any all right so that carries next month we'll talk about the next set uh just for the public's information as was just pointed out to me again uh the guidance documents required by law to go on virginia town hall which i guess the department will take care of and that's a 30-day comment period for the public and so i think that accomplishes all we needed with you guys is that So we were actually -- I think we lost our agenda -- or sorry, our PowerPoint.

[02:07:12] We were actually going to provide additional content on the Startup and Poor People Grant guidelines, but if those are for first review and you don't need that at this time, we're happy to defer it. Why don't we go through it now because we'll do final next time. Okay. We'll be fast.

[02:07:27] Can I get some help putting the PowerPoint back up, please? Thank you. So just to talk through this, we're at the third section of our agenda, which is over your eyes through this quickly so we're at the third section of our presentation which are the startup and per pupil grant guidelines for first review and we are looking asking you to to look towards this section of the presentation with an eye for feedback or questions so that we can ensure

[02:08:03] um that we meet those in the interim between now and the next board meeting uh so to start off with uh and we've provided some of this background but to give you more detail on obtaining approval for a lab school the eligible entity that's prepared to launch a lab school has to submit an application to the State Board of Education for approval and again we indicated that we were using that July 2012 form which was updated in March 2022 just with some technical corrections to again be updated to include those statutory changes the Virginia Department of Education will lead the initial review of the

[02:08:41] applications for approval to ensure completeness they will then pass that to the standing committee established by the board for a full review of the approval for application to make a recommendation to the board and then the board will receive the committee's recommendation and to determine the status of the application approval or denial and then once approved then the approved applicant must establish a governing board that executes that contract you can convene the governing board and execute the contract at the same time that a lab school is working on their startup and her pupil grant

[02:09:19] applications and submitting those applications and we just have one slide on the startup grant guidelines as articulated these are capped at 1 million dollars per applicant with additional funding considered on a case by case basis and in accordance with available funds they are meant to be one-time funds we've pulled out the common allowable expenditures here it's important to know that there's a prohibition for major capital expenditures for land acquisition new construction and building wide renovations and then there is an allowance for one-time renovation for

[02:09:55] alteration to instructional spaces and purchase of equipment materials furnishings things that would be necessary to create a vibrant educational setting for students to enter and then quickly on the per pupil grant guidelines the per pupil grant guidelines will reflect the funding grant request that cannot exceed the average per pupil state projected funding to educate a student meaning the statewide average per pupil funding including the state and local shares for a fiscal year which averages in 2023 at

[02:10:32] about ten thousand three hundred and seventy six dollars this may be lower than the per pupil expenditure number that you're familiar with around fourteen thousand dollars because it backs out those federal funds and any excess that the local school division may be expending per pupil it also again articulates common allowable expenditures and has that same prohibition for major capital expenditures and again makes the point that those initial startup costs should in fact be funded by the startup grant not the pro people operating costs

[02:11:05] and then finally one important piece to note is that there may be funding provided based on enrollment projections so there is a provision to ensure that if enrollment decreases by less than 20 percent the awardee will still have access to that award amount but if it decreases by more than 20%, there will need to be an adjustment in the award based on that projected enrollment versus actual enrollment.

[02:11:33] And I just want to end our presentation part before we take any questions you have by just reinforcing that everything that we have put into the design of this process has been about planning for impact and planning for lasting impact and lasting positive impact.

[02:11:52] And so please know that what we're hoping we see in the planning grants is because we've been so specific with what we're looking for is that people have to start planning for how these last beyond two years and before and how they last beyond this initial a set of a hundred million dollars that exists you know we would love to say that these are going to be so wildly successful in the general and that our our economy is going to continue to be strong and that next year the General Assembly will double the amount of money they put aside we cannot guarantee that I would love to say that happens what I can say is that we're getting outreach from national philanthropic organizations that are following what's going on and saying we'd like to talk about putting some

[02:12:30] dollars behind this to incent this we're hearing this from local employers saying that they want to be part of this we know that local school divisions want to partner with this so that's also a way to sustainability of making sure that local school divisions are part of this and so the dollars also stay within the system and that's a way of sustainability so we know that there are many ways that we can get to sustainability but what we are also just going to underscore. And what we hope is that no plans are approved that do not deal with the sustainability issue because this is not a flash in the pan approach. We do not want these to come and good ideas and excitement and energy that exists right now. And then it dissipates because

[02:13:06] we haven't planned for long-term impact. I want you to hear from us that we have tried to design this in a way that is about long-term improvement and lasting change and innovation that inspires this to happen in every school in Virginia so that's what we want to leave with and we know that came up in public comment and we just want you to know we hear that and we have designed this process to make sure that that is the long-term goal that we have innovation in all our school in all of our schools and that they're there they are making their plans to make sure that that is sustainable we're happy much appreciate your time are there any other questions

[02:13:41] at this point I just wanted to make just a comment that thank you for this is very detailed and um i'm thankful particularly for the timeline slide that you put in that's very clear and i look forward to this exciting venture this is fantastic good job thank you we're really excited too and thank you so much for the partnership and your leadership on the board for making this possible so thank you thank you so we'll see you next month we will we'll be

[02:14:09] be back okay before we do mr. Albin and item D can we move okay I'd like to circle back to item a and finish that up item a is of course the names of individuals to be certified by the board I would be happy to entertain a motion to adopt the list with the exception of mark Brian Taylor the view

[02:14:49] being that we heard enough this morning to at least inquire as to you know get more information about what's going on and whether the requirements were met. Is there a motion to that effect or any discussion? Thank you Dr. Siebert and thank you Ms. Creasy. Any discussion? None all in favor signify by saying aye. Aye. And any opposed? No. All right what we will do then I mean it's not a denial of of the license, that is, in fact, just a deferral to the September meeting, and staff will

[02:15:25] be engaged with Spotsylvania to get any further information that's needed. Okay, we're almost back on the agenda. Item D, Dr. Alvin, and Ms. Tennessee. Excuse me.

[02:15:44] I did not mean to exclude you. I need to read further down the agenda sheet next time. Good afternoon. Good afternoon. Good afternoon, President Gecker, Vice President, Dr. Mann, Superintendent Baylow and members of the Virginia Board of Education My name is Keisha Tennessee, and I am the computer science coordinator I would like to first thank you for the opportunity to speak with you again concerning the addition of the International Baccalaureate IB computer science course to the board's guidelines for the use of computer science courses to satisfy graduation requirements this item was presented for first review in June of

[02:16:24] As outlined in the standards of quality, a computer science course credit may be considered mathematics, science, or a career and technical education credit based upon a review. Currently, the IB computer science course may be used to satisfy an elective credit or it may satisfy a laboratory science credit requirement for students enrolled in the course as part of their IB pathway, and who complete all components of the IB Diploma Program requirements.

[02:16:59] At the request of stakeholders, including parents and school division counselors, the IB Computer Science course was reviewed to expand options for all students enrolled in IB Computer Science course. The rationale for this request is based on the current graduation credit options outlined for the Advanced Placement AP Computer Science A Course.

[02:17:24] Pursuant of House Bill 1054 of 2014, the AP Computer Science A Course was approved by the board to meet graduation requirements for mathematics, science, and career and technical education as seen in attachment A.

[02:17:42] Utilizing AP Computer Science A as a guiding tool, the review of the IB Computer Science course was conducted. The review consisted of an analysis of the curriculum guidelines and framework of both IB Computer Science and AP Computer Science A.

[02:18:02] Due to the high level of rigor of IB Computer Science course, the alignment of concepts and practices to the AP Computer Science A course and the contextual knowledge and skills aligned to the disciplines of mathematics, science, and career and technical education, the Virginia Department of

Education requests the board to approve adding IB computer science as an alternative to meet graduation requirements for mathematics, science, and career and technical education.

[02:18:34] In summary, the International Baccalaureate computer science course was reviewed for inclusion in the board's guidelines for the use of computer science courses to satisfy graduation requirements. This review was conducted by the Virginia Department of Education staff within the Office of STEM and Innovation and the Office of CTE.

[02:18:55] This request will expand opportunities for students to not only engage in rigorous computer science curriculum and instruction, but also the ability for parents and students along with the guidance of school counselors to assess the appropriate credit for graduation per successful completion of the course.

[02:19:17] Thank you for the consideration of this proposed edition of IB Computer Science to the Board's Guidelines for the use of computer science courses to satisfy graduation requirements. Are there any questions at this time? Are there any questions? Yes, I do.

[02:19:34] So, under the purpose of presentation, you mentioned action required by state or federal law or regulations. So, what are those? Is it just the HB 1054?

[02:19:51] - Under the purpose of presentation, it's just under the standards of quality has already been assessed that computer science courses must be reviewed. - Sorry, I meant which regulations and laws are you referring to? - Can I defer to Dr. Albarn?

[02:20:08] - Would it be possible for you to share where specifically that was? - Under the purpose of presentation, the very first. - First line. - The first line, action required by state federal law or regulation which law or regulation i believe that would just be the provision of the board of education to approve courses um for for graduation uh purposes in in virginia i can't cite the law off the top of my head but i'd be happy to get that for you yes please okay

[02:20:42] so which ib computer science are we talking about here there are two levels standard level higher level um and i did ask for thank you keisha and you sent me the standard the um the ap computer science i looked through all the curriculum and the i do see that the standard level and i've asked teachers around standard level lacks in rigor compared to ap computer science a in looking through all the course details and the high level course of course is rigorous has 240 hours devoted

[02:21:18] to teaching compared to only 150 for the standard level course so which one are you referring to here thank you for that question and for that distinction we were referring to the higher level course so we can make an edit to that yes please okay so my next question is that for cte credit here you mentioned that um students are required to successfully complete either the AP computer science A examination with a score of three or higher or the IB computer

[02:21:53] science coursework, right? So why is the proposal different and more favorable treatment for the IB computer science course? Why is AP held to a higher standard? I mean, if the AP exam score needs to be three or higher, what are the assessment requirements for IB? Just a coursework completion as stated because you know assessments assessments do exist for IP computer science and looking through it I see that there are mark schemes mark bands marks ranging from 1 through 12 1 through 6 so it cannot be just that the AP computer science 3 or higher or just a

[02:22:33] completion course completion for IB what is really the assessment requirement yes so I can summarize our discussion with the office of cte regarding the assessment component of the ib computer science higher level course some of that was in consideration of the comprehensive approach of the coursework within ib computer science that both includes the foundational understanding of not only the element of programming but also the writing component the critical level the critical thinking component that requires within the full ib scope of pedagogy and expectations of students

[02:23:11] so not only uh practicing or writing out say programming within the java language but within the ib hl the higher level curriculum it does include a full scope of truly understanding the devices that you are programming on as well as contextualizing how this is going to solve a problem based upon a student interest and based upon the needs of society at the time so what are the assessment requirements for ib currently as written it is for the coursework that through the completion of the higher level course it does not have the stipulation of the assessment score with the ib course so why would ap require to be a three and higher ap is pretty rigorous

[02:23:51] to it you know java and i do have the entire curriculum for all of them and ap is somehow held to a higher standard than ib it's just not very i don't think that makes sense to me what i could Requests or again taking my notes is perhaps a review again of the AP computer science a course or collectively look at both courses together But this review was exclusively on the IB computer science a course And so yes, we did utilize the curriculum framework and guidelines that were used to already approve the AP computer science a course to grant the

[02:24:30] graduation credit flexibility Within that but from the council within the office of stem and innovation in the office of CTE it was determined at that time the IB coursework. Right, okay. Just because the, sorry, did you want to add? I was just going to add to that, that the board has already previously approved international baccalaureate courses for approval for graduation requirement in other content areas, mathematics, science, English, and history.

[02:24:58] And we are holding IB computer science to the same standard, that the rigor of the course itself is of the same level as the AP. the AP since it is an external group. The content rigour is measured to be the same but as is the case with IB across the board, they do not have an end of course assessment much like AP does but the rigour is built in and today's request really just follows the norm of us being able to include International Baccalaureate for Computer Science to expand more options for more students to be

[02:25:37] able to get high school graduation credits for these. Thank you. Although there are-- assessments do exist, right, for IB. And it just seems a little unfair that all they're required to do is complete a coursework. I do agree. Coursework is-- why not have the same-- then why not have the same level for AP, just a completion of course.

[02:26:00] So it's just a little unfair that if they complete, whether or not-- if they score a mark scheme of one, Are they really still getting the same as an AP of three or higher? That's just a little bit. And, you know, my son has gone through the, he took the AP computer science A, so I know how rigorous it is.

[02:26:22] And so it just seems a little unfair. I would like to get that reviewed and see if maybe it's brought up to par for that. But, sorry, I just had a few more questions. May I? Can I make one distinction there?

[02:26:37] When it comes to that assessment, that's only for the Career and Technical Education credit. That's not a component when it comes to the Laboratory Science or the Mathematics credit. Got it. So that is not in regarding the Laboratory Science credit or the Mathematics credit. That is only what was agreed upon with CTE to provide a Career and Technical Education credit.

[02:26:58] So I just wanted to give that level of distinction. And then to follow up with what Dr. Albon said, just in regarding the elements of waivers are consideration of the IB course recognized in section 8 of the Virginia Code 20-131-51 there are elements of the International Baccalaureate that does not necessarily outline as we have outlined in the advanced diploma but it has been agreed upon that completion of the IB IB course the diploma pathway is recognized to the same rigor as the advanced diploma that we have so there is previous statute that that indicates that the coursework itself has been

[02:27:36] recognized to extinguish the rigor and the merit of the course that doesn't necessarily have to mean like an assessment per se this is not just for students who are doing an IB program right this is for anybody who can take an IB computer science as well yes correct so a part of the fairness is that currently the IB computer science course you could have two students in the same class and you can have a student who is taking the IB diploma pathway and only that student has the option to earn a laboratory science credit while all other students say they are partaking in the course so it it really does provide merit to the students who are in the course

[02:28:13] collectively regardless if they're on the IB diploma pathway because they're all sitting in the same course and they're all experienced the same instructional practices and learning the contextual knowledge of that course so it is to provide all students enrolled in that class the same level of opportunities to satisfy that graduation requirement and to extend that graduation requirement to include mathematics and career and technical education yeah i i do appreciate the fact that it's now more accessible

[02:28:45] so that's a great thing i just don't agree that if even if you say fail here you're still completed the coursework and you're still even for cte you know um that is um i think we need some assessments in ib as well i understand that there are there are a following certain standards set but since now this is moving on from outside you're you're just taking it apart and saying anybody now can take an ib can just great i think but i think we need assessments for that but um to if you're if

[02:29:25] you're going to put it on par with AP Computer Science A. And are there any other states that currently apply towards a math or science credit in high school? And what are other states doing in terms of allowing students to satisfy a high school diploma by taking an IB Computer Science class but not passing the IB exam? I have not done the research on which other states in regarding to the particulars of the ib computer science course but there are a number of states that

[02:30:00] leverage computer science courses that they do have to provide mathematics science and career and technical education credit there are other states that require a computer science course for graduation credit in particular we're looking at the ib course but different states may leverage other computer science courses this is only one list one course within the list of the computer Science courses that the state of Virginia offers I mean for math and science credit is what I was yeah Do there are so you've you've looked and there are other states who are but it not necessarily for the IB computer science

[02:30:36] Course I'm saying I do not have that data with me right now regarding the IB computer science course But there are other states that use computer science courses for a mathematics science and career

and technical education credit We'd be, sorry, Ms. Datta, we'd be happy to get that list of states for you.

[02:30:57] And if I may, could I go back and answer a question previously? You were asking about the legislation that was driving this essentially 2014 House Bill 1054. Okay, 1054, okay. That is reflected in code, I could get that as well.

[02:31:14] Right, and so you mentioned here in your presentation that AP Computer Science, a or ib computer science currently provides a student selected verified credit for students who successfully complete a career or technical education program sequence um or successfully complete either the ap computer science a with a score of three or higher or the ib computer science core work coursework so this is a verified credit we're talking about here right the virginia code does not appear to require the state board of education to let students take the ib computer

[02:31:52] science course but never taking or passing the ib exam to get a verified credit designation please could you explain that could i ask for you to repeat that question one additional time i'm sorry yeah so here um your presentation there was a paragraph where you said that um i think it's maybe the last paragraph so as paragraph yes last paragraph where you say that um ap computer science

[02:32:28] a or ib computer science currently provides a student selected verified credit for students again this is who successfully complete a cte program sequence in programming and successfully complete either the ap computer science a with the score of three or higher or the ib computer science coursework and the the virginia core code does not really require it does not appear to

[02:33:01] require the state board of education to let students take the ib course but not you know to get a verified credit verified is different from a standard credit so it in the code i couldn't find where it requires the state board of education to let the students take the ib computer science course but not pass an assessment so is this a comment um referencing your previous uh question regarding an assessment for ib computer science i'm reading the statement it's a little different because this is verified this is a different part of why are you know now we are giving them a

[02:33:41] verified uh credit for not even passing uh an exam or taking an exam which is different from a standard in math or science why i think the answer just goes back to the initial my initial response before just in regarding to our initial discussion between the two offices and we can definitely go back and review this to make sure everything is in alignment when it comes to the verified credit okay and now keisha would you also please put together a table showing the various standards currently used um for all the um computer science a b and ip classes including the

[02:34:20] you know sl hl for ib and also please together put together crosswalk that um shows the difference between all of these courses for the purposes of the math the lab science and the ct requirements could you please do that yes okay and do you have a timeline for when you would like to see that crosswalk and who should we provide that crosswalk to so that you may receive it the board of education would be great yeah and i just wondered in terms of what kind of meetings you had with teachers who have experienced their knowledge in this area and i'm just a i just don't agree with

[02:34:59] some of the language in this so i i just don't think it should be rushed thank you for your feedback are there any other questions for members of the board okay so what is the desire of the board here i i would like for this to come back up again at the um to see if the language can be maybe reviewed and edited to some of or at least provide an explanation for some of the questions

[02:35:39] that were asked today i mean is everybody else comfortable voting on this today and i am not and i i just don't think it's enough information yeah um no i i certainly understand and support the desire for us to establish a high level rigor having taught in an ib school having been assistant principal of and superintendent for an ib school i i hold the ib program at standards in very high regard uh there are both the internal the external assessments that that occur um so i i have no concern about the rigor of international baccalaureate computer science right no it did hl computer

[02:36:19] Science definitely seemed it this just didn't make any and I understand that there are internal and external assessments It just didn't make any reference to whether those reference those assessments won't be counted in any way Which I think they should if you're counting the AP assessment. Why not IB as well? Mr. President. Yes, may I suggest this is on final review That if we go forward on final review today the department can follow up with miss duda as the issues she's raised and we can come back

[02:36:54] guidelines are easy enough to revise again in the future for instance if there's something we should adjust with respect to the ap classes so with that said i i i could if we're ready to go forward on final review i'm i'd be prepared to offer a motion that we proceed and accept the guidelines on final with you today i'm president gecker um to address the concerns that have been brought up by the board perhaps we can uh you all can make a decision regarding the science and the lab the laboratory

[02:37:30] science of the mathematics credit component since a lot of the questions have been pertaining to the career and technical education section of the document that is just a recommendation of consideration let me ask what's gained by splitting it um we would like for this to go into effect immediately for students who are currently enrolled in iv computer science for this upcoming school year that that was actually mr president anticipated my question which is the same one as earlier so if we were to delay what would the effect what would the practical effect be on uh kids and educators uh the likelihood if we're if we were to go into effect immediately

[02:38:07] the cte component does have a sequential uh element to it with the sequence of the two computer science courses that they would take so i don't see that this would cause too much of a distraction or the tier for those who are currently like seniors in the course and it could be retroactive for students who may take it this year who were a junior and then take another course that still provides the cte sequence requirement but even for cte though would can that can they be more equitable for the ap and ip to have an assessment for ib as well and that is my request for for perhaps the board to vote on the first two parts of of this

[02:38:46] document and to hold the other part for career and technical education for additional review and your crosswalk so additional review with CTE regarding the cut score so the score that students would need to pass for the IB course and so that that is my request and just suggestion to the board any of the board members have comments okay is there a motion of any type I'll move just for

[02:39:24] purposes of moving along i will move that we accept for final review of the item e uh item d guidelines we have a motion which to accept all of it i take it is there a second to that motion second okay motion a second all in favor signify by saying aye so sorry is this not splitting it not splitting it this is the motion was not to split it yes okay sorry okay that's okay let's

[02:40:01] try this again all in favor signify by saying aye aye those opposed no no mr hanson i'm sorry i missed it i'm sorry about that all right so that motion carries thank you all thank you okay item e final

review of updates to board approved courses to satisfy graduation requirements for the standard advanced studies and modified standard diplomas in virginia public schools dr

[02:40:31] alban thank you very much good afternoon president gecker vice president man members of the board superintendent baylow and a special welcome to the new board members before i begin um we will certainly make a point to provide you with with all of the information you've requested on the last item regardless my name is brendan elbon and i am the director of the office of stem and innovation here at the department of education i'm proud to share with you today for final review

[02:41:05] the proposed guidelines to the board of education approved courses to satisfy graduation requirements for the standard advanced studies and modified standard diplomas in virginia public schools the board approved courses documents includes a list of courses within stem fields and humanities content areas which are already approved by the board of education for the conferring of credits for high school graduation in Virginia. It includes information for students and parents to see the

[02:41:40] list of options which may be available within their Virginia public school, information for receiving school divisions and institutions of higher education about courses that students have completed including the school course for education data known as SCED code, and information about SOL assessments that are associated for Virginia courses. On June 15th of 2022, the proposed Board-approved courses document was presented to you for first review. At this time, no

[02:42:16] comments have been received since first review. Some of the updates to the November 2020 document include an update to the title of the document which refers to the Modified Standard Diploma and removing content specific to students who have aged out of Virginia public schools.

[02:42:37] We have updated for accuracy SCED codes used to identify courses in which students are currently enrolled. We have added a section which includes the awarding of credit in English. We have added data science and mathematics, which the board approved as a mathematics course on March 17th of this year.

[02:42:57] We have added international baccalaureate courses in all core areas to comport with de facto approvals. Clarifications and updates have been made in language regarding state and federal testing and state graduation requirements.

[02:43:17] Unnecessary and outdated content have been removed, and accuracy, readability, and formatting has been improved. Please note that this document serves as a corollary to the Computer Science Graduation Board Item D approved just a few moments ago, which includes IB computer science for mathematics and science graduation credits along with CTE.

[02:43:44] So therefore, I will ask that if the board approves today, that we will have approval to add IB computer science to the mathematics and the science areas. These updates are necessary to ensure that school divisions have appropriate notation of course enrollments in the master schedule collection and the appropriate credits are used to satisfy graduation credits, as well as to answer questions, to clarify answers to common questions.

[02:44:19] Therefore, the Superintendent of Public Instruction recommends that the Board of Education approve the proposed updates to the Board of Education courses to satisfy graduation requirements for the standard, advanced studies and modified standard diplomas in Virginia public schools.

[02:44:38] For final review. Thank you. yeah and if i may just kind of just refer to since dr alban you mentioned about the the previous course the previous item keisha did say that she's going to edit it to have an hl right ibhl yes ma'am okay so the the course that you approved would be the course that would go into the document and it's the hl version even for the prior one that is correct i um so for some

[02:45:14] Some of these, like IB chemistry and physics, do they also have an HL and SL distinctions? And if so, which ones are we talking about here?

[02:45:29] I'd be glad to jump there because I need to make sure to answer accurately. Yes, they are HL courses. Would you be able to please add that here because it's not mentioned?

[02:45:47] Yes, ma'am. And I did have some other questions. So application and interpretation, IV mathematics.

[02:46:07] Looked at the SL and the HL. SL focuses about half of the HL time on algebra, less than half of HL in geometry and trigonometry. It has about 60% of the total instructional time of HL, yet it is classified as above algebra too.

[02:46:30] That just does not make sense to me. How can this be included as a course above the level of Algebra 2 when this focuses so little time on Algebra, you know, the Algebra 1, Algebra 2?

[02:46:50] If this were approved, if this were included as a course above Algebra 1, I'd be all for it. but to include it as a course above algebra 2. Both of these SLs, which is either the application and interpretation or analysis and approach, both the SL do not belong above the algebra 2.

[02:47:13] The third point, so, I mean, yeah, the SL has some calculus, but it doesn't even delve into, like, addition or subtraction of like algebraic fractions or rational coefficients how can it be classified as above algebra too it just does not make sense to me certainly um if i may allay to some of your questions as we take a look at graduation credits and mathematics in virginia um we do build up through a vast range

[02:47:49] of mathematic skills from kindergarten all the way up now as we get into the middle school years there is a strong focus on preparing students for algebra, and it almost becomes a bottleneck. But once we get through those courses of Algebra I, Geometry, and Algebra II, then the courses do become a lot more diversified with regards to the actual content taught. You may have a course such as Trigonometry, or there are other courses that may specifically be light in algebra skills, but they are very rigorous mathematics courses. So when we talk about what is at or above the

[02:48:26] level of Algebra II, we're not talking about how much Algebra II content does it have, we speak about the rigour related to that particular content itself. But if, like I mentioned, if Algebra, in order to qualify or to be able to do Algebra II, you need to be able to um do you know certain certain um calculations on an algebraic rational

[02:48:58] equations which the sl both of these sl i i think do not belong above the level of algebra two the other point is is that i spoke with some data scientists and this is about the data science i you know it's it's it's great i love the course it's got a lot to do with you know data planning management data ingesting visualization data processing but i just don't think this this belongs in the math in the in the computer science yeah and i just don't think that um it belongs um

[02:49:38] what do you do you have any comments on that for data science certainly there are many stem areas that data science does touch on. You are correct that it folds very nicely with computer science, but it

is more home far better in terms of mathematics because it builds on many of the probability and statistics skills, and it does align more with that content than going directly into programming. There is a strand within the data science course itself where the students do get

[02:50:15] to touch some programming using some applications but but the whole course doesn't fall under yeah only when you get to very more mathematical computations or modeling but i i mean my my child also took uh research statistics but all of that really should be above the level of algebra one not above the level of algebra two is all my all is all i'm saying it doesn't belong above algebra two it belongs above algebra one and um so i would like to know what you think about that if

[02:50:49] you think you would want to maybe go back and review that and look at it again and i did also have a final question the uh one of the footnotes below the math section i think talks about sol test for algebra one geometry algebra two and it has the word test replaced with assessment and the word required, replaced by needed? Could you explain that?

[02:51:19] So we have been speaking about assessments in standards of learning to assess learning rather than just to test students per se. And the word assessment is actually more common with what is appropriate for assessing a level of learning rather than just a test. So the word test is actually perhaps inappropriate than what is more appropriate being assessment. And needed there where it's the needed it just provides for a clarity is that this assessment will be

[02:51:53] administered when needed to meet verified credits so when a student needs to meet those verified credits you have to understand that with different diploma types there are different numbers of verified credits that need to be reached in for example a student might only need one verified credit in order to get a standard diploma, it doesn't mean that if they take geometry, it doesn't mean they're required to take that geometry assessment. They would take it if it's needed in order to graduate. So would the assessments be also just like

[02:52:30] internal assessment, but not a test or an exam? No, this is the end of course assessment that aligns to each of those SOL content courses that we have established in Virginia. If I may, could I go back just on another broader idea? When we speak about at or above the level of Algebra II, what we are really looking for is we are looking for students to ensure that when they get a graduation, to get an advanced studies graduation point,

[02:53:06] that they are able to work at a level of rigor that is at or above the level of Algebra II, not necessarily treating it like a scale where we are going to say here is Algebra 2 and then everything is above that level. So when we take a look at something like data science, data science was very intentionally and deliberately designed to be a rigorous course.

[02:53:26] Now the content might be, sorry, the content might be different to the Algebra 2 content, but the rigor level of it is at about the same level as Algebra 2. Another question, just going back a little bit ago with regard to the application and interpretation, IB courses is that Algebra 2 is a prerequisite for students to take those courses. The completion of Algebra 2 is a prerequisite for students to take those courses.

[02:53:55] All of those, all of the four that were added? Yes, those application and interpretation courses, the standard level courses. Standard, not the higher level.

[02:54:10] Yes. So the two standard level and also data science or not? no data science can be taken without algebra 2 but um that but we do more or less it's is at the same rigor level as as algebra 2 but

algebra 2 is not a prerequisite to take data science i would beg beg to differ on the rigorousness of the data science just having looked through all the curriculum i just don't think it's at the same level of algebra too but i um i was just wondering

[02:54:48] if you would consider moving that above one not to data science um certainly we would be able to to to entertain any request that the board does have but just our thinking at the time about having it at or above the level of algebra 2 is for us it had to do with graduation requirements previous version of this document did not have that um bolded portion that says courses at or above the level of algebra 2. the purpose for that was to help guide school divisions to know which courses would include, if a student is going to get an advanced studies diploma,

[02:55:28] then they really should have, from this list of courses, at least one of those. Dr. Siebert. Mr. President, if I might maybe offer peace of mind to a colleague and also ask a clarifying question. Yes, sir. Again, my experience is dated, but indeed, IB curriculum exists for juniors and seniors.

[02:55:48] Therefore, prerequisites of algebra two, geometry, even trig before beginning the IB maths is very common. So I don't have any concern about the at or above piece on that. The question earlier, though, was about, you know, specifying HL higher level. My concern there, again, and this is dated, so I know enough to ask a question, but maybe not enough to be close to right, that if, like, biology is, to be higher level in biology, it's a two-year course to be higher level biology.

[02:56:14] However, chemistry, SL, is usually a one-year course. So I'm not sure about the applying the HL to all the courses, because I think that in the sciences, there's some distinction there. So I did. Again, that may no longer be the case, but that was my understanding at one time. I would have to find out more on that before you say.

[02:56:31] I'd be reluctant to add the HL requirement when it may not apply to all the sciences. Maybe now it does. That is correct, yeah. Dr. Rotherham. So I have an observation that I'm pretty sure about and then a question that I'm not. My observation is I'm pretty sure Ms. Dutta has, since she woke up this morning, forgotten more about these courses than I know.

[02:56:54] so i come with uh i come with that and that begs the question when we talk about rigor rigors rigor is one of those things like beauty right it's in the eye of the beholder often so could you just talk and this may be also to put people at ease like how are you actually determining that level of what we say this course is equal to in rigor or greater like how are we actually like deciding that well there is much built into what we would consider rigor if we were to take a look at data science, much of that content is new, which means that that gap of time in order to jump into brand new information is going to be. The outcomes of what students have to do is a lot

[02:57:31] more vast. Students have to be able to demonstrate mastery by actually doing things rather than just taking a test or being able to answer something. They have to be able to demonstrate that they have being able to learn the skills, and then be able to apply them. The levels of mathematics, something very important to remember is that this course was designed in such a way that it could be a full-year course, or it could be a half-year course that is combined with another course. For example, a very good example would be probability and statistics, which is another one. So it really

[02:58:06] works very nicely when it is a condensed course for your high-speed, you know, your high-track students, but in terms of the students who are doing it within a full year's time, they might need that

full year in order to get that fourth math, but there is a huge leap for them in terms of new content and new expectations of output. Added to which, just to be mindful that this content wasn't necessarily dreamed up by any of us or even a textbook company, the data science

[02:58:45] course itself was developed particularly aligned to data analytics and data science programs that already do exist in higher ed institutes. We worked with both UVA and George Mason University to take the components of their course and to say what would be relevant and appropriate to bridge back to high school so that students could take that which they know in high school and be ready to move into data analytics at the university level. So these concepts

[02:59:16] they weren't just something made up it is based on higher ed skills specifically all right we may have exhausted this one where are we as a board so did you say you were going to go back and check on the hl for some of the ibe sciences yes ma'am okay i guess the usual question if this is not approved today what's the downside it is that time of year where um schools are scheduling students

[02:59:49] into classes, and they are looking to ensure that they have appropriate ... So these courses are all previously approved by the board, but this document, what this document does is it provides a framework and a map for school divisions to be able to look at to say, yes, this is a Virginia credit. If it's not on the list, then I've got to call someone at the DOE, and that answer is probably no. With this being fresh out there, there are a whole lot of answered questions in terms of IB, for example, not previously having been there, I, like Dr. Siebert, spent a lot of time out in the western half of the state where IB was never really considered because it was not

[03:00:29] perhaps done that often, whereas in certain other parts of the state, hey, you are doing IB, you mean that counts? Oh, let me check. Yes, there was a superintendent's memo or there was something else. Putting a lot of these courses into this document makes it very clear for every school division in Virginia to know what courses would earn students high school graduation credit and it would also communicate to families what courses my child can take in order to get a high school diploma. The current document that we do have is outdated. What this does is it

[03:01:08] provides that at this time where schools will be preparing their master schedule collection soon. mr president i have a question yes ma'am uh dr oven am i correct i i'm sorry i'm not understanding this very basic question but that this document is simply an updated summary of decisions we have already made about what courses qualify and for what requirements or are we making decisions on any of these courses as part of approving this document very good question thank

[03:01:46] you miss holton apart from ib computer science these are all courses that have previously been approved by the border of education for graduation credit so this document is really other than the ib issue that we addressed in prior item this document is really just updating an explanatory document that helps parents and students and staff counselors etc understand what we've already done made decisions about in previous regulatory actions and other actions yes ma'am in which case

[03:02:18] why isn't this a superintendent's memo as opposed to a board action well i believe in things such as the data science course for example one additional course is why it's here you said there was one course that were oh that would be the ib computer science that we just so is that why it's here instead of being you know sort of a supes memo saying here's a new summary for you folks of prior actions the existing document that the board has approved out as a board approved courses document is outdated so we wanted to be able to put out an updated board approved document

[03:02:57] i wouldn't want to put that out without your approval there are these five above algebra right that that that's algebra two those are the five that are new which i'm not happy about the two sls and i hate saying no so many times i'm just not happy about those two sls being added above the algebra 2. other than that i mean i'll take your word for it on the data science even though i think it ranks between algebra 1 and algebra 2. president geck we just wanted to make sure it was

[03:03:32] good that this is a current guidance document that's posted um by the board under its approval on the town hall website town hall so the um the thought was that because it's currently list as a guidance document should come back to the board to continue in that format even though we're breaking very little new ground here correct it's just it's an update like we would normally do for any part of all right uh once again is there a motion on behalf of the board or no motion

[03:04:01] on behalf of the board i i would move that we accept the item on final review pursuant to the superintendent's recommendation second yeah we have a motion in the second uh all those in favor signify by saying aye aye aye aye aye any opposed nay all right mr or dr alban item f may i grab

[03:04:35] some water sure and does your time spent in the western part of the state explain your accent or what i need to i can do that sir all right change of streams so item f president gecker vice president man members of the board superintendent baylor i am joined by our health and physical education specialist dr danny ulmer road and we are delighted to present to you today for final

[03:05:09] review the proposed physical education standards of learning curriculum framework on june 15th the proposed curriculum framework was presented to you for first review at this time no comments have been received the proposed curriculum framework serves as a companion document for the 2022 physical education standards of learning which the board has already approved and adopted in March 17, 2022. The review of the 2015 Physical Education Standards of Learning Curriculum

[03:05:45] Framework was done in collaboration with K-12 physical education educators, higher education faculty, curriculum specialists, and other stakeholders. The review included adding the Board-adopted revisions to the 2022 Physical Education Standards and changing the layout of proposed curriculum framework to mirror the two-column structure of the recently approved curriculum framework for the health education standards of learning the 2022 curriculum framework is divided into elements that include essential understandings and the essential

[03:06:22] knowledge and skills that students need to achieve and maintain lifelong health and wellness to facilitate bringing the transition to the new format the broadening and broadening the scope of the proposed 2022 curriculum framework a dynamic technical assistance document that mirrors the 2015 curriculum format will be maintained and periodically updated within the seven-year review cycle to to reflect emerging best practices the 2022 curriculum framework is organized into

[03:06:58] strands that provide clarity for learning expectations and scaffold skill acquisition for motor skill development, anatomical basis of movement, physical planning, and energy balance. The goals of the proposed curriculum framework are to assist teachers in providing students with the knowledge and skills necessary to develop and apply a range of skills needed to improve health and to prevent and control chronic diseases; to engage in home, school, and community engagement

[03:07:31] that projects and enhances physical and mental health to explore a variety of physical education related career opportunities in health science human anatomy physiology sport and exercise

science education biomechanics coaching fitness and community health management to acquire workplace skills and to practice effective communication self-management stress management and collaboration skills therefore the superintendent of public instruction recommends the board receive for

[03:08:08] final review the proposed revisions to the 2015 physical physical education standards of learning curriculum framework thank you i do have a question about this social and emotional development could you elaborate on that so within physical education as you know there are

[03:08:46] opportunities for students to be involved in games and to participate and also for teamwork activities and a lot of that is seen as building into those social and emotional goals i do have dr alma road who's more intimate with this than me if you want to jump in feel free sure um we actually in the 2015 physical education sols we did have this strand but it was social development and so there was the edit in this 2022 that was SOLs that was approved, adding and emotional,

[03:09:24] so social and emotional learning. There is a lot of research that supports the integration of physical movement, physical fitness with social and emotional health, and that is one of the components um that is just as important as developing motor skills being able to plan fitness programs for later in life as well as learning about energy balance in versus out what what are how would you i mean what are the details i mean i just say critical and creative

[03:10:04] thinking so what what is included in the social and emotional development so the social and emotional strand is scaffolded from kindergarten all the way up to through the elective courses that we offer as well we focus on rules safe primarily also safety i'm not sure if you all have been in a gymnasium with 35 year olds in a kindergarten class but safety definitely needs

[03:10:38] to be first and foremost a part of that learning we also are the first state to include the scaffolding of inclusion from first grade all the way up as well the inclusion of build skill abilities and then not just including adaptive physical education students in our class but being able to understand inclusion as a whole could you elaborate on that what does inclusion

[03:11:15] of scalability mean so just as in a classroom you are going to have varying skill levels in a physical education you're going to have those who have participated in youth sports their entire lives you are going to have those who um prefer not to play team sports so there are different interests there um so there is a wide array of possible of what you will see in a physical

[03:11:45] education gymnasium um also including students in wheelchairs so is this all this terminology is all i'm getting at where is this all geared towards like sports or physical activity or is it a different there are different other components um it's actually just stated in click throughout the document it is just the term inclusion without any defining factor okay i mean um yeah i it's

[03:12:21] just such a open to interpretation um inclusion i just don't know what that you know it would be great to have i i might just provide a little bit of context for that in um in a curriculum framework um the the interpretation of inclusion would be much more narrow than it would be in another context. So we're really, inside of an education-ish document, like a curriculum framework, inclusion

[03:12:54] is specifically different skill levels and specifically, you know, it relates to IDEA, FAPE, and the way that we have created least restrictive environments for our special education students to include them in academic and physical activities during the the school day so in this context um i can tell you i'm really

comfortable with using the word inclusion um within the the curriculum framework and i feel like it's not too open for interpretation okay thank you

[03:13:35] any other comments or questions if not is there a motion thank you i'm sorry there was a second from somewhere? Thank you, Dr. Mann. Dr. Mann. Thank you, Tammy. All right. All in favor, signify by saying aye. Aye. Any opposed? Aye. Okay. I don't know about y'all. I need about a 10-minute break.

[03:14:02] We've got on, and we've still got a bunch to do, including the executive session. So

[03:14:07] thank you all for your work, and we'll be back at 3:40. All virtual folk? Yeah. All right. Item G,

[03:22:06] first review of proposed revised 2022 history and social science standards of learning. Cristania, I guess I should call you Ms. Brown. Excuse me. Cristania is fine. Cristania is fine. Okay. I think, you know, it's sort of you think of different people differently mentally. With you, I always think Cristania, but I should be more formal at the meeting, so.

[03:22:25] That is perfectly fine. Good afternoon, President Gecker, Vice President Mann, a hearty welcome to our new board members. Thank you so much. and superintendent baylow it is my honor to present to you today for first review the proposed revised history and social science standards of learning before i get started i really would like to take this time to introduce you to our team um sitting directly to my left is mrs brandy mccracken she is our elementary specialist and next to her is andrea emerson

[03:23:03] she is our secondary specialist and then next to her is the leader of this five tag group dr christine harris um acknowledging thank you so much christine for the support and contributions and guidance that you've provided to us i also would like to acknowledge dr shelley loving writer assistant superintendent of student assessment accountability in essa programs and specifically to assessment staff members, Holly Cook, Chris Teixeira, and Adam Bennett.

[03:23:38] They worked with us during the review demonstrating a true partnership between instruction and assessment during this review. I also truly appreciate the active role that Superintendent Bailo and leadership have taken to contribute to the standards development process by creating the new community roundtable engagement sessions that we hope to begin soon. I think you'll find that this presentation today will echo the sentiments just delivered by Governor

[03:24:15] Youngkin that we should teach all our history in Virginia. The good and the bad, the amazing progress that we have made in this country, the times that we have failed also. The history and social science program at the virginia department of education has taken very seriously and an intentional approach to the review process most importantly i would like to acknowledge the hard work concerted efforts and valuable contributions of the committees who contributed to this process

[03:24:52] including the teachers the content supervisors student representatives historians college professors museum educators leaders and representatives of various cultural excuse me various commissions parent and business advisory groups and cultural organizations through their volunteering of their time and committing to serve on the history and social science standards of learning review committees educators and external the history and social science program was able

[03:25:28] to gain input from institutions of higher education professional organizations and others and with an interest in history and social science in all eight superintendent's regions across the

commonwealth additionally i want to acknowledge the community at large for submitting over 5 000 public comments for the for the committees to consider and begin this journey so that's my introduction let's get started just to give you a brief overview of what we are going to go through today um we'll talk a little bit about the standards of learning themselves

[03:26:07] the review and revision process the public comments briefly that we collected the review committees that we established to go through and develop the document developing the standards document the progression of the curriculum framework and i know that um you've had other items today where the curriculum framework has been discussed so i want to give you no pun intended a history of the history and social science curriculum framework and then what we went through to review and revise the content and our expected next steps although this is um

[03:26:46] no news to you this is the code of virginia that basically establishes that the standards of learning belong to the board of education i bring this slide up because this is something that we have in every presentation for our review committees in any time that we provide professional development teachers we let them know that the document that we are developing is being proposed developed and proposed by the department of education but the board of education has the last say in that document and then lastly that second paragraph goes towards the definition

[03:27:24] which is stated in code of diversity and that is one that we used as we were developing this document the next slide basically goes into the instructional program of a school division they are to create an instructional program program k-12 that is aligned to the to the standards of learning so i bring this up because many times this is going to go right into our vision go into the goals of the review as we are developing standards for your approval eventual approval it is up to

[03:28:02] the local school division to develop their local curriculum that is aligned to those standards so our vision as we started this journey back in really before january 2021 we had a vision we brought together some teams of division level specialists to talk about history and social science education in the commonwealth where would we like that to go what would we like to see and i'm not going to read this to you but one of the big things that came out of those discussions

[03:28:36] with those practitioners was that we want to value history and social science as more than just content that we memorize but content that our students can do something with for post high school success and i really like what we have here in a sense that the standards are more than just passing a test we're looking at the standards one to honor our collective history really taking into account that no single narrative is going to be enough we really need to look at those multiple

[03:29:12] perspectives. Make informed decisions and take informed action. Lastly, because students have that information, they have that content, they are able to respond and engage in ways that benefit our communities, our state, our nation, our world. So with that vision, we set goals. And goals for this particular review and revision, first off, was to really look at those diverse stories that contribute to our history, whether that is American history or world history, whether we are

[03:29:51] talking about history or the other social sciences such as civics, economics, and geography. During the 2015 review, we did a lot of work to build up the social science skills. We noticed that our other disciplines had a skills progression chart where skills were introduced early learning and then progressed throughout up until graduation. We wanted something like that. Up until 2015, we had skills, but they were kind of all over the place. So what we wanted to do was to streamline

[03:30:25] that. During this review, we wanted to continue that. We've had a lot of success with teachers recognizing that skill development is just as important in history and social science. Next, over the past few years, there has been a lot of research dealing with inquiry-based practices.

[03:30:47] And so we wanted to look at this document as more than something where students memorize a list of facts. How can or what can we do to help them understand and apply the content that they are learning? And then lastly, based on recommendations from various commissions, we decided to introduce concepts and themes.

[03:31:11] And that would be something that could be introduced to kindergartners, but really look at the content that is umbrellaed under certain themes. The development of this document, holding true to our goals for the review and the revision, we wanted to make sure that we kept in mind the profile of the Virginia graduate.

[03:31:34] Hopefully, you will be able to see throughout the document opportunities for content knowledge, workplace skills, community, and civic responsibility or engagement in career planning. Also, holding to our goals of the review and revision, the five C's were approved by the board slightly right after the approval of the 2015 standards.

[03:32:03] So we did not specifically have them in the 2015 standards, but through our history and social science skills, we were able to point towards all five C's. We wanted to continue that during this process.

[03:32:22] So the standards of learning. The standards are basically defined or describe the expectations for student learning and achievement in grades K through 12, and all of our disciplines are listed there. standards versus instruction and this is many times something that we try to make sure that our students excuse me our teachers understand as we are building our standards the standards are used by school divisions to divide to design their local core instructional program known as tier one

[03:32:58] the tier one is implementing well-researched programs and practices that have produced good outcomes for students and we got this language from the Virginia tiered system of support which is provided to us through the office of special education continuing on looking at standards versus instruction the work that we were doing during this review and revision of the standards is not towards developing a curriculum but those broad statements as defined

[03:33:32] as standards it is the local school division that makes the decisions about to meet the needs of specific students so keeping that in mind we have standards versus instruction standards versus a curriculum and we are developing standards that are a statewide baseline so no matter what whether you are in bristol whether you are in norfolk whether you are in danville there's a baseline

[03:34:08] that of expectations that students should know and be able to do by the conclusion of a course versus a curriculum where the instructional program should emphasize the development of students abilities and the content that they are acquiring to apply to the standards standards for us vertically align and represent a goal or outcome of an educational program whereas a curriculum you'll see more appropriate accommodations for diverse diverse populations

[03:34:45] of students and how to best support them so that they meet the goals of the standards standards and this is something that we have that we discuss with teachers all the time standards do not dictate lesson plan formats or unit plans formats. That is something that is taken care of within a

curriculum based on the needs and goals of the local school division. Standards are statements that should be able of what students should be able to do and are not a narrative or an instructional

[03:35:19] or an assessment task. They do not set those. Whereas the curriculum will have many different resources that will highlight the pacing, that will highlight the full body of knowledge covered, that will highlight the assessment models used. So let's talk a little bit about the review and revision process. This is something different. We have always had, well, we've had standards

[03:35:52] since basically 1995 and in 2001 moved towards developing a curriculum framework for history and social science. Prior to presenting the timeline to the board, we were advised and or directed that we needed to develop one document and that one document we needed to review and revise the curriculum framework and standards at the same time. So keeping that in mind, we did go ahead

[03:36:26] and present our timeline to the board in January of 2021 and since then moved towards collecting public comments, meeting with review committees, and here we are at first review. What I'd like to do is to talk to you a little bit about the public comments first and then we'll go through the different committees and what those committees were responsible for doing when we met with them.

[03:36:54] so our public comment and there's a chart there we collected these public comments through a google form so each individual if you wanted to complete more than one google form you had that every right to do fill out as many as you like um to do what you see in the second column google form submitted that's the number of forms per course but within each form you could make more than one comment so let's say that you were commenting on the kindergarten course you might want to comment on

[03:37:30] k.1 k.3 k.7 so that's all on one form but there's three comments per form um this was a record for us during the 2015 review of the standards we collected a little bit less than 2 000 comments from beginning to end so we kind of superseded that during the first public comment um section so our review committees we started out um like i said earlier with our practitioner

[03:38:07] steering committee and we call them the practitioner steering committee because number one they're either content specialists or coordinators at the division level for a school division and their main responsibility is history and social science instruction, instructional delivery, supervising teachers. Many of these practitioners have a K-12 perspective and are able to help us with that vertical articulation of content and skills.

[03:38:38] Our historian committee, we invited six historians, I don't want to say just historians, we had three historians one to deal with world history two to deal with american history and then we had a political scientist an economist and a geographer and what we pulled them together to do was to look at our curriculum framework and the content of not only our framework but also our standards and give us some initial feedback where do you see that we may have gaps what would

[03:39:13] you suggest when we're talking about consistency in language where do you see that we may want to kind of consolidate content one of the biggest complaints that we have from many teachers is that there's a lot of content for us to cover in just 180 days next we met with for the first time an external with an external student advisory group and i really enjoyed um meeting with this group we had representatives from all eight superintendents regions, but they were selected

[03:39:49] by a regional superintendent, two students per region. We met with them over Zoom and really had a discussion with them about their K-12 social studies experience. And by the end of the first meeting,

one of the students said to us, you know, I really don't feel comfortable being the representative voice for all of the 1.2 million students in public school in the Commonwealth. How can we do something different? And what they collectively came up with was a survey and they developed questions for the student

[03:40:28] survey. They sent them to me. We put them in a Google form and they sent out that link and it wasn't as many students as they wanted to collect data from, but But it did give a good sense that we could probably do some more with this.

[03:40:45] So that Student External Student Advisory Committee, we met with them twice. The first time was just to discuss their personal K-12 experience. And then the second time we kind of discussed the data that we received, and I have a little bit more about that further in the presentation.

[03:41:04] Our next group was our Education Committee, and this was made up of educators from across the commonwealth they applied for this position and they were outstanding in a sense that when we met with them virtually over zoom we met with them for two weeks many of them we asked that they commit to about four days on zoom all day but they were so very interested in doing this work that many times it went beyond four days with some of our education committees our next group

[03:41:38] was our external museums and organizations group the last time during the 2015 review we had an external committee but it was one committee made up of historians college professors and museums and organizations and there were about 35 of those there this time we decided to split that group into two different um committees so that we could bring in more museums and more organizations. I believe that in a previous presentation, we had a listing of those

[03:42:18] museums and organizations. And I have my cheat sheet here, so if there are any questions about that a little bit later on. And our next group was our external historians and professors. based on our document there are major topics that we have k-12 for example you're going to learn about the civil war in virginia studies us-1 and virginian u.s history and slightly mentioned in

[03:42:51] world history 1500 to the present suffice it to say we needed a expert on the civil war so we we contacted, of course, the American Civil War Museum and others that have an expertise in the Civil War. And I believe one of those people was Dr. Edward Ayers, who gave you public comment today. Next, we had our external parent advisory and CTE business leader committee. This group we came to after our new leadership came in. It was a suggestion from Superintendent Balo that we reach

[03:43:30] out to parents, and we started with the Virginia PTA, and then we reached out to the CTE and the business leader community. The next is a chart that gives you basically a listing of all of our different committees, how many people were invited, and again, outside of our educators, this was basically volunteer, and this is the number of people that we had to actually commit to working with us to review and revise the standards our next slide i wanted to give you a visual

[03:44:09] of the location of the members on our different committees this first one is our practitioner and our educators committee the educators committee and practitioners committee they worked very well together and worked very closely when it came time to that first stage of of the review and revision.

[03:44:32] The next added to that, we have our museums, organizations, professors, and historians. And then lastly, Virginia PTA advisory, CTE, and our business leaders.

[03:44:53] I spoke earlier about the student advisory committee. We met with them in May of 2021. And again, they developed questions for a survey. There was a 25 question survey that they put together. And what I've done, your next slide. This is a slide that I thought was very interesting. We put out, well, the students came up with this question. In your school experience, which of the following topics do you

[03:45:22] feel are overtaught or overemphasized? And again, you can't teach U.S. history without teaching the Civil War, almost any of the wars that we've been involved in. And so we had a discussion about this particular question, and I asked, what is it that you feel like we can do differently, especially when it comes to the standards document, when we're writing standards? And a couple of students said, it's not so much, we know that we have to learn the Civil War each time we're in a U.S.

[03:46:00] history course, but we're learning the same thing. What I learned in Virginia Studies is not much different from what I'm learning in Virginia and U.S. history. Some of the same people were doing some of the same things. It might be at a higher level and the words may be longer, but it's the same thing. That was like a light bulb for me. I've taught this content and really mostly at the secondary level. And until I went to the central office, I really didn't know what was

[03:46:35] going on in Virginia studies. So to have students tell me this, this was an eye opener and it really helped when we went to our educators committee meetings i wanted to give you a graphic of the number of educators and practitioners that we have working working with us when we were reviewing and revising the standards and you can see from every region from where they came we met with the

[03:47:06] educators committee again july 12th through july 23rd for two weeks but before they came to us we of course as teachers we gave them homework so there was some reading pre-reading that we really wanted them to do so that they had an understanding of what the tasks before them was going to be first we asked that they review some national documents i'm not sure if you're familiar with the c3 framework but it's the document put out by the national council of the social studies

[03:47:38] and it is a framework for what states can use to build their own standards um another document that just recently came out was the educating for an american democracy document that came out it too is a roadmap or a framework for developing state standards that document was released in march of 2021 you can tell by the list that we really looked at the national standards for

[03:48:10] are four strands history civics economics and geography another thing that we did for our educators for this committee we prepared for them what we call a landing page everything that they would need was linked in a customized page for them for this review this was done all virtually and we had the opportunity to use zoom and breakout rooms and they had everything that

[03:48:42] they needed on these pages and i do apologize i believe in the first presentation that you had some of these were hot links and some of them were screenshots so again i apologize for that but if you would like to have access to them all i have no problem providing them for you they were also provided with all of the public comments based on the grade level or course that they were there to review this next slide is an example of how they were able to access those

[03:49:16] public comments this is the same thing that you see as attachments b3 through 14 on the board dots so what you received as far as public comment that's exactly what our educators committee received once you click on that link this is the type of slide that would come up for them they were able to read all

of the comments public comments for their particular course so the next thing that we wanted the educators committee to do was to take the curriculum framework the curriculum

[03:49:55] framework is made up of not only the standard but also the understandings the assent and the essential knowledge we wanted them to go through and read the public comments read this curriculum framework document discuss it as a group come to a consensus of any changes based on the public comment and their experience as a teacher for changes for any type of change that they made we ask that they completed that they were to complete a rationale form this helps us track

[03:50:35] any of the changes and why a committee decided to make a change to the content our program has collected all of these different comments so again having access to them we know the course the change that was made and the rationale that was proposed for that change from there the document moved from our educators committee moved to our museums and organizations and much

[03:51:08] like our educators committee our museums and organizations too were provided a landing page we invited museums and organizations to come based on their area of focus or area of expertise.

[03:51:23] This slide is an example of the strikethrough proposed revisions from the educators committee comments made by an outside, excuse me, an organization or a museum making comments on what the educators were proposing. From there, the document then moved from the museums and educate, excuse me, museums and organizations to our historians and professors. And again, like our

[03:52:02] museums and organizations, they were able to have a customized landing page with everything that they needed. They would make comments into their own strikethrough document and provide us with feedback. The difference between the museums and organizations and the professors, the professors were able to see everyone's input so they could comment on what our museums gave us because many times museums have museums and organizations they have their areas of focus but it may not

[03:52:37] always be historically accurate or it's coming from their perspective or lived experience so So, from there, we have museums, organizations, educators, and now our professors have provided input for us.

[03:53:01] Everyone had access to the public comments. That was something that if they requested, we had no problem giving it to them, but they had so much that they had to look through, we didn't want to overwhelm them. We did have some museums and organizations, and we did have some professors that requested access to those public comments for what they were providing input on.

[03:53:23] This next slide, our team worked to make sure that we were able to track everyone's coming and goings for two weeks at a time, sometimes three. We had different professors coming into the Zoom meeting rooms because they were doing this voluntarily in between teaching their classes.

[03:53:46] So we were able to track and make sure that we had feedback and input on our entire document. From there, our document moved from our historians back to our practitioners' committee. And we brought it back to this group because we needed for them to work with us to reconcile the document.

[03:54:08] We have input from so many different committees. group having looking at content through a k-12 lens they would be able to help us to reconcile the input that we got from everyone from there we

were able to meet with a few um parents and cte and business leaders even though that was after we brought the document back to our practitioners

[03:54:42] which was fun we were still able to collect their comments and their input and it was really valuable and helpful for us because for example our cte advisory committee was able to give us some insight about the use of work-based readiness skills and how we could possibly incorporate it into our standards document so we have gone through all of our committees and now to look at combining it into a standards document we had many discussions about what this document

[03:55:18] should look like we had many discussions about um how can this document best help school divisions with developing their local curriculum um we reconvened the practitioners committee in february of 2022 and met with them even though it says april there there were a few committees that we were that we needed to meet with during the month of may from in this new standards document we knew that we wanted to make sure that we transferred the standard of course the substandard

[03:55:55] the understandings and what would this new structure look like well we did a lot of research looking at inquiry practices and one of the main components of inquiry practices are questions compelling questions and supporting questions so we thought each of our standards could have a big compelling question or we renamed it an overarching question and then to build up to that overarching question present supporting questions that would help teachers with that content knowledge that we

[03:56:33] need to make sure that students have so this next slide basically lets you see all of the different places that standards document traveled before we got to the structure that you have before you so let's talk a little bit about developing this document the development of the history and social science document again looking at the history of the standards document or the history

[03:57:04] of the curriculum framework and again standards in 1995 and our first curriculum framework really appearing on the scene in 2001 that document was basically established to help teachers with students taking the sol assessment multiple choice assessment back in the day there was for example um the standards themselves were very very broad and as a matter of fact this particular

[03:57:42] standard looks at the impact of the geographic features, but I want to bring your attention to where it says major rivers. And you see that we're talking about the Atlantic Ocean, the Chesapeake Bay, and then major rivers, the fall line, the fall line zone, and the Shenandoah Valley. But it does not list what those major rivers are. And in Virginia, you know that we have a lot of waterways.

[03:58:12] so in 2001 because that first round of sol tests teachers were very confused as to what rivers should i focus on and by 2001 there was a resolution by this board the board of ed to develop a curriculum framework that curriculum framework was a companion document to the standards so the standards went a little further with the description by 2001 we identified those

[03:58:47] rivers, those major rivers. VS.2C, the 2001 curriculum framework document in the essential knowledge column, not only listed those rivers, but gave you two facts about each of those rivers.

[03:59:09] By 2008, we had another water feature that was added, same rivers, identifying and locating water features. And then the curriculum framework expanded the information for each river. What we found what's happening here was that students were learning the rivers and they were memorizing the facts about those rivers and then we moved on to the next there was no real discussion or opportunity

[03:59:45] to really discuss the impact of those water features or the impact of those rivers on the people the environment the political or social development of a location this has been the case with these details since 2001 leading up to our 2015 document so in developing one single document

[04:00:18] we had to consider number one we have received over 5 000 comments for the history and social science standards. Number two, we really wanted to think about incorporating inquiry-based practices, making sure that we stay true to the history and social science skills. Think about how we can infuse literacy into our standards and make STEM connections, and then really think about our workplace readiness skills. The reality of it all is that there has been, over the past 20 years,

[04:00:57] a greater focus on memorization and less of a focus of understanding the content and making connections the reality is we need to have supports for educators to develop curriculum once you get passed um into regions six seven and eight you are least likely to have a history and social science coordinator at the division level and many times the development of a curriculum is left up to teachers or a division level administrator that wears many many many hats

[04:01:34] and then lastly there are only 180 days of school and we're talking about the history of the world civics economics and geography in 13 years 180 days at a top it's a lot of content so what did we change? Well, the first thing that we changed was we really relied upon our practitioners, our K-12 division level administrators. They worked with us to help combine this document. We really

[04:02:10] thought about what was in our front matter. And in our current standards document, we have a preface and we have an explanation of all of our different strands. We wanted to make sure that that front matter did more provide more support for people who have to use this document to provide more support to parents who pick up this document and wonder what is going on with these standards what do teachers use to teach the standards we wanted to make sure that there were literacy and work

[04:02:45] based readiness skills infused in this document we wanted to make sure that there were overarching questions and supporting questions what better way to teach history and social science than through questioning discovery research communication reading and writing and lastly in this new structure we didn't want everything to change we wanted to make sure that there was something familiar from the documents that we have currently to this new document to help teachers communities

[04:03:24] transition to the new document so this is what we added we felt like there needed to be guiding principles for effective history and social science instruction we went through with our themes and our concepts the themes and concepts are basically from the national council of the social studies and from the report from our african-american history education commission we're introducing inquiry-based practices what does that mean what does that look like so we

[04:04:01] created an infographic that helps teachers understand the use of questions sources and tasks and instruction our skills progression chart our skills progression chart we've had since 2015 but we wanted to make sure that it was with the document previously or currently right now it's a link outside of the standards document but we wanted to make sure that everyone understood that the skills are just as important as the content so it has been placed inside of the

[04:04:39] document next we had our course introductions which basically tells you about the course but we've added a section that goes through what students learned before they came to this particular course, what they're learning in this course, and what they should see after they leave this course. So if you are a

second grader, your teacher knows what you should have been learning in first grade. They understand what you're going into for third grade.

[04:05:10] We also wanted to infuse into this section workplace readiness skills. Our new structure also proposes broader statements. So for this particular, going back to our rivers, for this particular standard, we did move the names of those major rivers because we really want people to connect with their local history. I live in the Tidewater area and the Elizabeth River is not

[04:05:46] listed as one of the major rivers, but the Elizabeth River is very important to not only the history of Tidewater, but the present commercial, economic, social development of the Tidewater area. Another change. So with that broad statement or broader focus in the standard, one, to connect to local history, we also added the overarching statements or understandings.

[04:06:22] We brought that over as something familiar from the curriculum framework. We added supporting questions. At the K through Virginia studies level, you're going to see more supporting questions than you will in our secondary courses. That is building that foundational knowledge through those supporting questions. Knowledge and learning experiences. Learning experiences is also something that we brought over from our curriculum frameworks. The 2015 curriculum frameworks, the first 10 pages of all of those frameworks have what we call learning experience

[04:07:01] to help teachers understand how to build in or infuse the skills into their regular instruction, combined with the content from that essential knowledge column out of our curriculum framework.

[04:07:18] So all of the content that you would previously have seen in that second column labeled essential knowledge is addressed either through the supporting questions and or the knowledge and learning experiences. And then lastly, in 2001, after the development of the curriculum framework, another document that was developed was the enhanced scope and sequence. The enhanced scope and sequence we pulled in 2017 because it was no longer aligned to the 2015 standards.

[04:07:53] But what was great about that document is that it provided not only the standards and resources, but it also gave opportunities for activities and sample assessments. So knowing that this is going to be a shift for our teachers, for our students, for our communities, we are going to be working on, especially once our standards are approved, we will be working on content sources and resources for teachers and communities to consider as they are teaching these standards. Using the enhanced scope and sequence as a model

[04:08:32] of what we used to have, we would like to provide teachers with the standards, activities, sample assessments. So again, although it looks different, what we've done is we've taken the standards document and expanded it. Everything that you would find in the section labeled essential knowledge from our curriculum framework our 2015 curriculum framework you will find in the

[04:09:05] supporting questions and the learning experiences so how did we make the decisions during the review the first thing that we consulted with were our public comments this particular public comment is for virginia studies and it is specifically looking at again the rivers the educators committee considered all of those public comments and what we've provided for you here is a rationale from

[04:09:39] our educators committee next our external committee members gave us input also what you're looking at now is their input based on that same standard based on that same revision from our educators

committee when we pulled our practitioners committee back together to reconcile the document of all of the input they looked at what the educators committee did as far as revisions

[04:10:16] deletions changes and they helped us to go to develop supporting questions and our knowledge and learning experiences but what about the content we got lots of content especially from our cultural organizations that they provided on those strikethrough documents we collected all of that content and made decisions how do we one either incorporate it into the new standards document or two develop a resource in or a necessary professional development we know that

[04:10:54] there is content here that is going to be new to many teachers we know that we're going to need to provide resources and professional development to build their content knowledge and capacity through collecting that data on this chart we now have it so we know where we need to and who we need to connect connect with to provide those resources and content knowledge this is this is an example of um the enhanced curriculum map that is a i guess upgraded version of our enhanced

[04:11:33] curriculum excuse me enhanced scope and sequence this document we hope that it will contain teacher guidance connect overarching questions and supporting questions go further into those this those learning experiences or disciplinary skills and offer cross-curricular opportunities whether it is a virginia studies teacher connecting not only virginia studies with fourth grade science

[04:12:03] but also reading and math next this is just another view of what we'd like to add to that document to provide support especially for those school divisions that do not have division level administrators for history and social science the document also considering the fact that we'll need to help them with professional development providing our professional development

[04:12:39] listed, not only in the document, but available as kind of like a living document on the DOE website. So the revision of the content, I promise you, this is the second to the last section.

[04:12:55] The revision of the content, one of the first things that we wanted to look at is the language consistency. When I say language consistency throughout our standards, throughout our previous curriculum frameworks for example we referenced virginia indians in four or five different ways k-12 virginia indians native americans american indians and what we wanted to do is to make sure that we introduced terminology in kindergarten that it went all the way through our government

[04:13:30] courses so consistency in terminology or language was very important um a heavier focus to make sure that we had opportunities for literacy connections. We have had a great focus on using a variety of information sources rather than heavy reliance upon a textbook. We wanted to also make sure that we provided opportunities for content and scaffolding. Changes to our skills

[04:14:09] progression chart. We've been very happy with the skills progression and the only major change that we made to the skills progression chart was to add a skill of contextualization k3 our k3 focus at the beginning of all of our standards for kindergarten through third grade they are going to start with a civics focus we had also the idea of really looking at that terminology or that

[04:14:45] concept of community and introducing it in kindergarten and as a student moves from kindergarten through third grade they experience their community around them now the state the nation the world and being a member of each of those communities um again there's a greater number of supporting questions and learning experiences in k3 because it is building a foundation of content knowledge and skills for virginia studies i won't read all of this to you

[04:15:22] but what we really wanted to do with virginia studies is to look at specifically developing a standard for indigenous peoples um that's a big change that we made a standard that not only looks at prior to European contact, but also looking at their lives today. We've worked very closely with the Virginia Tribal Education Consortium. They were able to send a representative to work with us on

[04:15:56] the external committees, both the historian and the organizations. Our U.S. history middle school courses, we did the same thing, making sure that there was a specific standard dedicated to indigenous peoples prior to Colonial America. We expanded the focus on the development of the Constitution, having a greater focus on the documents used to develop the Constitution,

[04:16:29] and more opportunities to connect past and present. For our Civics and Economics course, the major revisions there again focused on the development of the Constitution and the documents involved. Mr. Gecker I promise it's not much longer now. We were hoping you'd at least go until five. We were hoping you'd at least go until five so we're in good shape.

[04:17:02] Okay I can do that. So with civics and economics another thing that we wanted to focus on was civic engagement. We've received a lot of comments over the seven years that there's a great emphasis on voting and voter turnout and making sure students understand the branches of government but we've gotten comments about local history local and state history excuse me local and state civics and government but also really thinking about civic engagement for middle school

[04:17:41] students they may not be able to vote but how can they become civically engaged for a world geography course this course is the course that took more of an overhaul than any of our courses what we were finding with this course was there were a lot of facts that were almost random and really did not connect so we wanted to think about this course in a sense of what major themes can we run with this course we also looked at the um nate assessment curriculum and the ap human geography

[04:18:20] course and kind of modeled the content after what we found in those standards excuse me in those curriculum for our world history courses most of the um content for those courses changed looking more so at the benefits and costs and interactions of societies um we had a lot of

[04:18:52] organizations contribute as far as a narrative and giving us content that we had not had before in these courses but what we found is that um we really need to focus on building content knowledge of our teachers because a lot of the content that was proposed may be unfamiliar to our teachers.

[04:19:19] We did reorganize and tried to make sure that there was a balance when it came to religions, societies, and regions. It used to be in our 2001 and 2008 standards, for example, Greece, ancient Greece and ancient Rome, there were eight or nine substandards. And when it came to other societies or civilizations you kind of breeze through them so we looked at how can we balance this so that students get a balance or more or a more diverse understanding of the world

[04:19:57] next we had um a lot of information moved around for virginia u.s history mainly just like our virginia studies course in our middle school u.s history courses we looked at that dedicated standard for indigenous people. You will see fewer questions and fewer learning experiences because we are really trying to focus on depth versus breadth. We did reorganize the last few standards of Virginia and U.S. history, mainly because we wanted to make sure that our standards

[04:20:36] went past 2001. That's been 20 years. So how can we support teachers teaching the present and connecting it to the past. Lastly, oh, I keep forgetting to advance the slides. My apologies.

[04:20:57] Lastly, Virginia and United States government. We reorganized and reworded the standards for government, focusing on levels of government. We looked at the national government, the state government, and the local government. What we found from what we received from the Fordham report was that we did not have that much of a focus on federalism. And federalism is a very

[04:21:33] important political principle, but our standards really didn't have a focus on federalism. So we tried to make sure that there was content surrounding federalism. So I went over some of the changes fairly quickly. I do apologize, but you all have been here for a very, very long time.

[04:22:00] In the end, what we are advocating for this discipline is that we approach history and social science instruction differently. Memorization is no longer going to be enough. We have to help students understand the content and rather than memorizing facts to help them connect that content. Our next steps, we are looking to continue if the board accepts this document for first review to establishing or scheduling public hearings and then leading

[04:22:39] towards final review. From there, Superintendent Baylow has requested that we engage the community across the commonwealth in a discussion about the process and the changes made in our community engagement roundtable sessions these sessions would be different from our public hearings in that there would be interaction between staff and the community that attends and we are able to gain input and feedback on the document that we are proposing and make those changes as may be

[04:23:17] necessary consider the feedback they are giving us and explain to them the process and the changes that we have proposed our pathway to full implementation once the standards are finalized and final approval from the board we move to create a crosswalk to help teachers parents communities transition from the 2015 standards to the 2022 standards we know that we will need to develop content and resources and professional development so the community engagement roundtable

[04:23:56] sessions will help us gather data as to the type of professional development that we need to do for not only our teachers but also our communities because this is going to be something different for not only our educators but also for our families so as in code the standards of learning in all subject areas are subject to a regular review and revision to maintain rigor and reflect a balance of content and the application of knowledge in preparation for eventual

[04:24:36] employment and lifelong learning that is our biggest goal of this review and revision of the history and social science standards at this time if you have enough energy we will take any questions that you may have or feedback let me start just for a second did it before five you did thank you uh the code section site of course is a little bit incomplete and it might be beneficial for the board to understand that our obligation and responsibility to do standards of learning is in fact delegated to us actually directed to us by the assembly and the code

[04:25:13] section goes on to say that the subjects at hand, in this case history, needs to be reviewed at a maximum every seven years, and that the board shall adopt a process by which that gets done, and then shall follow that process, and then the statute stipulates or mandates that we go have public hearings, right?

[04:25:35] So that's a piece of it. You know, one of the things I've found helpful in the last couple of years on the board is to understand what the source of the obligation is you know so we understand what needs we're fulfilling for example the board for years didn't do standards of quality and then finally in the

although constitutionally we're required to uh finally in november 2019 for the first time in two decades we the board actually did a prescribed standards of quality which went over to the legislature that's one that's granted to us through the constitution similarly in the constitution

[04:26:13] the reason we approve superintendent's list, which we were not doing for a long time, is the Virginia constitution says the board shall approve a list of names who shall be eligible for the position of superintendent. Before this, I mean, before the board actually read the constitution and said this is something where we have to do, the department basically did it on its own. It never came to us. There were lists that were kept. If they thought people met the requirements, they They were put on the list and the license was enough.

[04:26:44] Another area is accreditation, which will come up at some point during your terms, right? Accreditation is one that's not constitutionally granted to us. It's legislatively granted, and there are parameters around what we can do. Similarly, the standards of learning is a thing that we're required to do by the legislature, not by the Constitution, and there's a process set out in the legislation that requires us to do it.

[04:27:10] Part of that process is, as I said, we're supposed to set up a procedure, which the board has done, and we can't do it, and we're supposed to do it within every seven years. As Kristania mentioned, the last time the standards were revised was 2015, which is why the board began in actually December 2020, I think, was the first meeting with regard to the history standards.

[04:27:33] laid out the process, the board approved the process in accordance with the legislation, and the department has been marching down that process since that time to get us to here. Again, it's not random, and it's not just administrative, and it's not, gee, we had time to do it in the department.

[04:27:50] It's, this is what's required under the law for the board to do, including, as I said, the seven-year deadline. People have asked, why are you concerned about 2022 being the date of adoption? The answer is, that's what the code requires. And since I've been on the board, we've been, I think, pretty good about, you know, meeting the requirements of the code, whatever those requirements are.

[04:28:14] And, you know, we don't have independent staff. We rely on the department, and Emily, I don't mean any disrespect there, but you work for the department, although you are our liaison. And, you know, the work that's been done to date, of course, has been done by the department on our behalf.

[04:28:31] But again, the timelines are set for us legislatively. I don't like to see those timelines slip because, you know, once we start, although there are no penalties built in the code, you know, the whole structure of the education system in the Commonwealth is built around different bodies having different responsibilities.

[04:28:50] Right? You've got local school boards who have got exclusive operational control. You've got us who are subject to the ultimate authority of the General Assembly. We have the rights to do certain things, right? And you have the department involved in this.

[04:29:05] But when one group starts sort of ignoring or not living up to the expectations that are placed upon it, you know, lawfully, the system begins to slide apart. And it has been one of my goals, you know, in this role, to have the system not slide apart as we move forward.

[04:29:22] And so there has been a push to move toward a resolution of this in 2022, long before this became what appeared to be a political issue for unknown reasons to me. Honestly, I would think reasonable people could sit down. I mean, I will tell you, I don't have the qualifications, background or otherwise, to talk about the content.

[04:29:42] And I hope today's conversation doesn't devolve into content. We ought to be talking about where we're going from here, what the timeline looks like, and what we can anticipate on the other end as the end date by which we can provide the product that we're required to provide statutorily.

[04:30:02] And I'm hoping, at least for the beginning of this discussion, we can move it in that direction, his timeline now i know the superintendent has said you know oh let me ask one content question though yes sir wasn't george washington the father of my country he surely was how come you took it out of the standards i read that in the news you read that i did my apologies and um that especially as the leader of this group i take full responsibility for the missing of pasting

[04:30:38] yeah it looked like because it said it was moved and then it didn't show up no it looked like an error but it seemed to have been picked up by the press as gee all of a sudden virginia doesn't want to recognize washington and madison which of course is ridiculous we're not at the point yet even of discussing that but that's sort of a silly thing to pick up in any event uh if we can can we entertain first sort of the timeline issues. And what that means to me is our next step statutorily is to hold public hearings around the commonwealth. And frankly, they can be

[04:31:16] simultaneously with or before or after the other groups that I think the superintendent rightfully has said ought to participate, right? I am plainly happy to have more participation in the process of generating these standards rather than less.

[04:31:33] At the same time, I do want to be respectful of the timeline that has been legislatively set for us. And, you know, I'm wondering from the group, I mean, are we capable of moving this forward in a way that respects both the legislative mandate and sort of a desire to take a deeper dive into what's out there?

[04:31:55] Now, and I will tell you, Cristania, although I am not a historian and, like I said, not really qualified to judge. It seems to me that the job you guys have done, and certainly for the first 14 months of you doing this job, everybody said, this is a good thing. And I understand we're moving from fact-based to inquiry-based. I mean, I get the conceptual shift.

[04:32:18] I don't know if that's good or bad. I'm not an educator either by training. Dr. Sievert could tell me if this is a good thing or a bad thing, but that's not where my strength is. But I do understand sort of the systemic requirements. And if we could, as a board, talk meaningfully about how we anticipate moving this project from where it is today, which is a 400-page document, to final standards, I would appreciate that. And then I will take, I promise you, you can have as much time as you want to talk about the content of it today, although we

[04:32:54] do have executive session after this, and I'd appreciate at least some discretion on and how much content you wanna go into. But I will stay here as long as necessary. The board will stay as long as necessary for everybody to feel like they've had a shot at talking about it. But the mandate is we have a November in theory deadline.

[04:33:12] How are we gonna get from here to there? - President Gecker. - Yes, ma'am. Yeah, Dr. Mann. - Yes, and I do appreciate the expediency and the need to move things forward. But I would just be remiss if

I didn't just say how extraordinary I found the presentation that took the board through the process in a most thoughtful and deliberative manner.

[04:33:38] And I actually think it would behoove us to think about, I know our meetings are public and people can stream in and capture the content, but I think the thoughtfulness that went into the approach bears understanding as we engage the public.

[04:33:58] And I would almost suggest that it would be great to have this extracted so that it could be easily shared. I know you can mark it and say, you know, tune in at this minute and that minute, but it is so important as we undertake an issue of this magnitude that we are doing it from an informed perspective, because we all have perhaps different personal opinions about what we may wish for or want to see.

[04:34:25] But I think the level of attention and thoughtfulness the expertise that has been tapped including parents and students and it's extraordinary and I just didn't want us to launch into um sort of a a conversation without acknowledging the extreme gratitude I know I feel for the individuals on staff as well as those that participated in weeks of meetings reading seeking understanding to undertake the awesome responsibility of helping us

[04:35:01] get these standards revised so i i just needed to kind of get that out there and on to the timeline we can go but this was this was an exceptional model for deliberateness do you mind if i say you've got prepared remarks i do have a couple of prepared remarks that i've shortened over time because Cristania has done a great job presenting and we are nearing five o'clock but you know I had an opportunity to do a news interview this afternoon and said look Virginia likes to be the best at everything and we want nothing less than the best standards for

[04:35:38] our students in history and social science and I think the common ground is that we are well on our way and I want to commend you Cristania and your team on the work that's gone into today's presentation uh and the heavy lift that you've taken um over the course of the last two years so um that said i do just uh just want to um i want to to just explain my recommendation to not accept these for first review and it really comes down to two things number one is time and

[04:36:12] number two is um is corrections so that this document is ready for prime time so i'll just quickly just go through number one time. You know, you did a great job again, Kristania, today. And I feel like what you laid out, as Dr. Mann said, is a playbook for examining and thoroughly analyzing these standards. We have five new board members who have not had that time. We have a whole board that is going, wow, what a great presentation today.

[04:36:45] And it would behoove us to make sure that especially the five new board members have an opportunity to review and analyze these standards within the context of your presentation as a playbook. And I think that's what I really heard Dr. Mann just say, is let's make this available so that it's a playbook for all of Virginia as we undergo public comments.

[04:37:09] this board has had an opportunity to really take presentations to um to think about how how the standards are framed to receive updates over the course of the last couple of years and again the five new board members have not had an opportunity for that so when i ask for a delay in first review i want to make clear again i think that there's much more common ground than not um in terms of you know digging into the content of this i'm not so interested in that either but i want to make sure that that this this board that's comprised of the members today has an opportunity

[04:37:48] to frame this this standards document in the same way that the the previous ford board members have and so i'm asking for one month so that we can hold briefings with individual board members and give more nuance give more information give them an opportunity to individually ask questions about the standards that they may have that might be content related or that might be process related. You laid out really well today. These are incredibly nuanced.

[04:38:19] This process is incredibly complex. And one month I think would do a great -- today was an inflection point. As you have laid out this playbook for us, for five new board members, really for all of us to be able to look at the standards process and the document through that lens.

[04:38:39] And one month would make a big difference and it would not, you know, we wouldn't be breaking code. We may not get it done by December of 2022, but we would get it done by maybe January of 2023. And as I understand it, as long as we're substantially underway and making progress, there isn't a problem with that.

[04:39:00] So I wanna make sure we get them right rather than staying to a rigid timeframe. And I wanna make sure that the five new board members have an opportunity to ask the questions that they need to frame the document as you framed it today on their own and away from this meeting and to ask the questions that they may have going forward.

[04:39:21] The second thing is just the corrections. Since the standards were publicly released in July and well before that we were receiving you, you humbly put up some maybe errors and joked about some errors, et cetera, and changes that were made.

[04:39:38] Some of the comments that have come back to the board, to the department, to the secretary, to myself, have really been around errors that are in the document, errors with organization, errors, an example might be using the word succession instead of secession.

[04:39:58] The George Washington being the father of the United States is another example. And then there are some content issues too, frankly, that I think have been identified. The omission of Plessy versus Ferguson is missing from the context of the rise of Jim Crow.

[04:40:17] That's really important to our whole history. And we heard today around the table and from the governor that that's really important to everyone. So I want to make sure that before these go on the street for this incredible work that you all are about to undertake going across the Commonwealth and holding community meetings with what may be hundreds, maybe thousands of people, that we have a document to put in front of them that is as close to a final draft as we can get.

[04:40:49] So that we aren't asking the Commonwealth to weigh in on typos or to weigh in on organizational errors, but truly have an opportunity to have it framed by this playbook that you presented and provide additional feedback on the process and on the content as we go forward.

[04:41:10] And again, that's one month so that we can make sure that we get those errors corrected, that we reach back out to entities. You mentioned Fordham. You mentioned the democracy. I can't remember the framework. Roadmap.

[04:41:26] Thank you. Educating for American democracy. So many partners, I believe, nationally would be willing to just help us and say, you know, move this here, move this here. teachers will be able to navigate it a little bit better in this in this respect and um and and i hope that we can take a month to um to

just do that work before these hit the street and you hit the road doing a series of eight possibly eight community meetings where um where this document is going to be front and center for everybody we want them focused on on the road to

[04:42:04] best not a draft to the best so i'll stop there i didn't even use my script how's that dan i think it's really like i said back to the board in a sense uh although it's clear again given the personnel issues i mean the board can't really control what happens to a certain extent right it's going to happen as the department wants it to from the board's perspective though you know and this is not about these standards it's really about everything we've done

[04:42:40] i don't find it acceptable to say we're going to move it into january to me we meet our deadlines that's what we do and uh if there something comes up that we just can't then we'll talk about it but truth is the department even under your leadership has had this document for seven months and if there are still typos and things you know i don't really understand that some i don't think you really expect the five new board members to review it for typos and content omission i think that's that's us yeah that's you guys yeah right i mean and so that can

[04:43:17] be done independently before we hit the road i would think honestly before you have the the final expert review we would want to hear from the parents and from the teachers in the field and from the public to get some idea are there any hot issues that we have not really picked up on and then blend the document into a final cohesive whole uh instead yeah um so thank you christiania um for this extraordinary presentation and thank you also for uh responding to my emails for all the primary source documents and i just realized looking at your um your presentation that i'm

[04:43:56] going to be asking for some more because i i didn't have a chance to look at all of your presentation i think there's a lot more that i'm going to be asking you to provide me so thank you and uh mr president thank you for um you know mentioning about the legislative um what the mandates are um and the importance of a deadline and a timeline um i i also do think though it's it's more important to get it right than to get it right on time so i do think that um i would need

[04:44:32] i mean i've gone through um some of the document not the entire i have lots of questions today i am concerned uh i would not be comfortable moving towards a first review without discussing issues i would just thank mr president go ahead ms holton uh uh yes thank you um well first i just want to echo um um tammy's comments uh miss brown you and your team have done a really extraordinary

[04:45:09] job and whether or not we all have well i'm sure all of us have submissions for improvement uh to the final product um and i have myself which i'm hoping to send submit to you um in writing uh shortly uh i am just overwhelmed with the extent of the engagement you have done with national experts as well as Virginia experts and and parents and business and students I love so the extent of engagement you've done and the quality of the work product the inquiry-based

[04:45:45] education which is what all the national experts including the Fordham Institute all support that approach you all have done a phenomenal job uh and so I echo that phrase um I do think we have uh a lot of work to do to get it finalized but i don't think delaying uh the process for a month will help us think that uh addressing the superintendent's concerns time for new members to be briefed on it absolutely new members and old members we should all continue to be engaging with this document uh which you know has been out there for six weeks now and we would love to

[04:46:21] have further briefings with with uh staff to help bring this along i see no reason why that can't go on simultaneously over the next two to three months as we work to gather further public input no question is do we delay starting the public hearing sessions and the community engagement sessions so that we can do uh clean up some typos first or so that we can brief members first and i just don't get how you know if wait to do that then it's going to be more than another month of delay there's just physically no way if you're going to do another draft before you go public

[04:46:57] then you have to come back at the september you have new drafts to us essentially in two weeks so that we can look at it in four weeks at the september meeting and then you start scheduling public hearings you're going to fall behind by more than the the timeline has suggested and i'm with um mr president that we should try to stay on our timeline so the notion that we can brief new members simultaneously with uh working to set up public uh comments and community engagement sessions i think works perfectly likewise i think the corrections um errors additions you're going

[04:47:32] to hear alora that suggested i i feel while i think it's a great document i feel very strongly that there are a couple of key um areas that are not adequately yet addressed i will say specifically that um the period uh from 1900 to the 1960s the exclusion of african-american participation from voting and political participation the deliberate efforts for instance in the virginia constitution in 1902 the very conscious efforts that were successfully taken to end the participation

[04:48:09] that had been happening during reconstruction is not adequately addressed redlining that excluded african-american participation in the the wealth of home ownership started by a democratic administration the roosevelt administration in the 1930s impacting uh um african-american community all the way up through the 1960s so i've got some content suggestions i'd love to pass on and i hope to and intend to pass them on uh to the state and hope that they're going to keep my comments along with the comments of my fellow board members and all the public and any national

[04:48:45] experts that want to further weigh in, in addition to the incredible participants. And we have national experts already involved, just to be clear, because some of the national experts are Virginia experts. President Ayers, who spoke this morning and who's been involved in this process all along, is among many of our Virginia experts, truly a national expert.

[04:49:07] So I don't mean to go on too long, but I think that we can engage the national experts. can correct typos and um and hear from the public about what needs to be added to do all that efficiently we should proceed on all on all um courses over the next couple of months and then we'll have a a lot to review we'll have a lot for the staff to review and a lot for us to review in october so that we can hopefully then finalize something in november and that's what i would encourage us to do mr president sir just again i'd like to thank you very much this is a very

[04:49:45] helpful in the amount of material with the 400 page document and the 100 page deck and the 5000 pages of public comment were a lot to absorb but there's a lot of work that goes into all of that so thank you for that um i just i guess i have two questions um one if we do delay for a month and maybe even two i'm still what's the implementation of this when would this go into effect there are there are a lot of things that can impact um implementation but one of the first things that

[04:50:19] we would need to do if there is approval whether it's november january between um this if we started by school years um september of 2023 we would up until that time we would be working on what's

called a crosswalk document before the board is the whole idea of um hq up hqim high quality instructional materials versus our textbook approval process and i believe that is still

[04:50:55] before the board um so we would need to get involved in that process to provide so that school divisions will have either a lit an approved list or what have you that plays into coming up between twin the 23-24 school year so we are looking at implementation not having this is barring anything from the general assembly or actions of the board that

[04:51:26] would impact assessment we're looking at full implementation sometime around 24 25 and the the pathway to that um all along the lines we would need to develop the resources and professional development but really hoping for full implementation 24 25. okay well just again i support the superintendent's recommendation for us to um as a new board member i would even ask president has there been a situation during your tenure where there's been five new board members

[04:52:06] appointed at one time i know it's not in the history of the commonwealth have there been five the system wasn't set up that way i think this is a unique time that we're in as well and i think that um it's incumbent on us and i would suggest the content does matter and i you know maybe we don't want to get into it today but there are a lot of things and i think a couple comments were made about the 1900 history and there's other things as well and i think there's also just frankly some assumptions just you know in slide 49 rather than memorizing the facts connect the

[04:52:41] content i frankly have a fundamental disagreement with that it might be in addition to the facts connect the content but it's not an either or in my mind and i think in any other spectrum whether it's our doctors or our scientists or our math you know facts matter memorization matters and you know again as a father of six kids who've gone through the virginia standards over the last 20 years and now my grandkids going through it it's important and repetition is important so i don't have a problem with repetition

[04:53:21] and it happens in other fields and so i don't know why we would want to take that away here for the um you know and i also would really like to have a little bit of a better understanding over the last seven years of where virginia has come down in our proficiency and performance of our students with the standards from seven years ago and um and maybe even going back 14 years and and where we rank nationally and naps whatever it might be and to really have an understanding of where we are as a commonwealth compared to the country and again we should be

[04:54:00] leading and so to me i'd like to have a better underbelly on a lot of this before we start going down to make some tectonic shifts in what we're doing here that could have a tectonic shift you know seven years from now of where we're going as a commonwealth and i think we owe it to ourselves to take a pause for the five new members here to be able to get our sea legs under us a little bit and to have a better understanding of um you know and again i would argue that content is important

[04:54:34] here and and mistakes matter you know i've had a lot of phone calls these last couple of days about the you know we might think it's funny about the george washington or james madison issue but just as an organization and as a commonwealth these are the things too that can get this whole process off the rails if we're not careful so i would really suggest we take a little bit of time get things right minimize the potential noise that's going to be disruptive and distracting versus getting it right as best we can out the chute so i would support enthusiastically the

[04:55:11] superintendent's recommendation for us to take a little bit of time take a deep breath and i don't see a practical challenge to us of what's going to if we're january versus november i'm getting this wrapped up and if i if somebody can make a case for me otherwise i would be willing to consider my position but to me you know expediency can cause problems if we're not careful and it should not be the tail wagging the dog for us i have no issue let me just say one thing tammy

[04:55:46] If that's okay first, with the idea the final product ought to have quality and that people ought to have time. To me, the question really is what happens within that month, the first month versus what happens in the last month. What I mean by that is the board has under its control final approval, right? We can march down the path from today till November and in November, the board decide, you know, we're not quite happy with where we are and not pass it, right? You have control over the output. You know, we used to say in my line of work, you know, all jobs expand to

[04:56:23] the time allotted. Meaning of that is, you know, you set a deadline, you know, hoping that you'll get there. And I'm not talking about sacrificing quality of the end product, because clearly, as I said before, if something happens, then we worry about it then. But to plan into the delay with no clear understanding, I mean, I don't believe it's the five new board members' jobs to go through and correct, if you will, the current draft. That is internal to the department.

[04:56:52] And one would hope that that could occur prior to a scheduled public hearing on the draft. And I'll tell you, if the concept is that we're going back and, again, I'd rely on educational experts to tell me the right answer to this, to fact-based instead of inquiry-based, it's not going to be January of 23. I mean, you're talking then about a wholesale rewrite of the standards, as I understand where we are. And so that's a decision that's going to be made. Maybe we ought to talk about that aspect early on, because there's nothing, I mean, it will not be an easy

[04:57:31] job to take the current work product and convert it to the other style, at least not from my estimation. And so, like I said, if I understood what a month bought, you know, what was going to happen? Are we just going to be correcting typos? Candidly, we're all in the same position of receiving the draft. I mean, the four of us have been through a bit of process, but the bit of process we've been through was approving the timeline. We were not actively engaged in the formulation of the draft. We're all starting at the same point. And so I'm not sure the newness

[04:58:10] or the oldness of the board member, you know, matters, you know, as much as it might seem to here. Mr. Rotherham, I think you had. Yeah, I wanted to give my colleague. Oh, sorry. I didn't see you, Grace. Okay. Yeah, so, I mean, I have a lot of thoughts.

[04:58:31] First of all, that was a great presentation. And I don't think, like, I think it's not, like, the amount of content you had to wrangle into, like, people might be like 104 slides, that's a lot of slides, but, like, the amount of content you had to get into that slide loop, like, it's an immense amount of content to manage and so thank you um uh i think the standards like they're pretty good i share my colleagues concern though i do think you know inquiry matters domain knowledge matters and you have to have domain knowledge to do inquiry and i think there's questions there about what that should look like huge questions there about teacher professional development teacher prep there's

[04:59:07] there's a lot there that i think we need so um uh but i think like there's a lot of stuff in there rather than they're quite good like um miss holton i have concerns about certain aspects i think what's interesting is the media is going to portray this this is left right or or too woke or not well i don't think

when you look at it i think the cons like when i look at the concerns i have they run like across the gamut of of different kinds of issues where things that are that i i worry we're not like we're not going to be fully flushed out and sort of how that's um gonna go and so i what i'm waiting to hear is like i i hear the deadline argument but i also hear

[04:59:45] that we can be on track we can wait a few more months i don't think it's the five new members speaking as as one of them my colleagues may disagree i'm only speaking for myself i think it's more i'm just not prepared right now given all these moving parts and so forth and i'm sort of i look i'm the last person you want to take carpentry advice from if you've ever seen anything i've built but there is a saying you know measure measure twice and cut once and i think we're sort of at one of those moments and we can ask ourselves like what's the worst thing that happens if we hit a pause and it may be a pause and then it opens up some broader issues that we want to look at um but i i think like it's worth at least pausing for a beat to

[05:00:23] kind of figure out where we are as a as a that that as a new board member or something i'm just not like uh i'm not prepared i feel like the governor came in here today and he said he wants to teach honest history he wants to teach the good and the bad we should take him up on that i do agree very much with this fallow i want us to have standards that every other state looks like and says you know what at a contentious time virginia has like really fantastic standards that are honest they're good for kids and so forth and this is a public process so it's not like we're gonna no one's it's not like anything's gonna happen out of sight people aren't gonna know what's happened here like there's a paper trail which again you have uh ably managed for us um and so

[05:01:00] people are gonna be able to see the process and and and draw their own judgments i don't i i'm having trouble seeing the risk of pausing for a beat again measuring measuring twice uh and and cutting once on this dr man thank you president gecker i appreciate your calling out that we're all at the same starting point i feel very much like as a sitting board member i got the deck the same time everybody else got the deck and had to move through that along with the standards by the way that we all just adopted for physical education i certainly know that they don't come with

[05:01:36] contention but nonetheless if we're thinking about or talking about holding standards in high esteem we certainly went through the process of approving those standards today both new and old board members i think the other thing i'd like to say is i i worry about the um the subtle message that it communicates to stakeholders that have invested a significant amount of time and attention from an expert perspective even though we feel there are things that need to be changed to say that

[05:02:09] we're going to pause on the work that individuals have undertaken for the better part of almost two years and not do our due diligence to move a process forward that simply involves inviting the public to get more involved in the discussion that that doesn't appear to be a message i think we want to communicate especially when you consider that we fast track other opportunities today in the spirit of really wanting to move on innovation and the opportunity to advance that absent really

[05:02:46] being able to see the full picture there is a measure of trust and process that i think is important for us to understand because we do all enter boards in terms of service with work in process and we all have to figure out how we come up to speed and so i i just offer those perspectives of things we should be thinking about as as we make this decision mr president man miss halton yes uh i very much appreciate all the board members desire to dig

[05:03:22] deep into this really important topic and and the superintendent's suggestion that our our goal for all of us is to get it right um and to have the best standards that we can and i i agree with all of that it's really more a question of what's the best way to move that forward um and i would just offer two comments one is mr rotherham i appreciate your measure measure cut just to be clear accepting for first review is not cutting you know we really we've already done the first review i mean first review was what we just heard a review of that we've had the documents in front of us for six

[05:03:59] weeks we we aren't asked to vote on anything at first review we simply uh move to the next step of public comment so i don't actually think we're in the measure measure cut analogy i don't think we're cutting anything we're not actually taking any action as a board until at least the october board meeting regardless of what we do today the one thing we are doing i would hope today is scheduling those public comment meetings and the starting the process of scheduling a public comment and committee engagement and so the one suggestion i would make is while i'm in favor of

[05:04:38] moving the process forward now if the will of the board is that we pause as the word has been used for a month uh as the superintendent suggests for the one month pause that we do use that month well and that we be clear that that means if the department plans to submit another draft for the use of the public that we get that two weeks before the september board meeting so that we don't lose more than a month so that we can all read it before the september board meeting also did it be redlined so that we can see the changes those of us who i mean i've read the 400 pages

[05:05:15] now and i don't want to read them all again so i'd like to have any changes between now and the draft submitted for our consideration in september be flagged um and then third i would like to suggest that again if there's a delay which a pause which i don't think there needs to be but if there is a pause that we um uh agree still today to begin to go forward and plan for our use of our time throughout the fall so there's no reason why we shouldn't now start scheduling is a is a bear as the staff knows scheduling this meeting was near impossible

[05:05:54] but can we start scheduling those public comment sessions can we start scheduling those community engagement sessions if we're not going to hold them before the september meeting can we at least get them on the calendar for the latter half of september and october so that we have the benefit of that all that input in timely fashion so all that's to say can we can we make good use of our time going forward so that if there has to be a delay it's not more than a month that we push things back yeah i was going to suggest actually and that we go ahead and schedule i mean the concept of accepting on first review really doesn't have a lot of meaning i mean we've heard the

[05:06:31] report you can't undo hearing the report it's just sort of there uh as the superintendent points out however it does start some time frames i would be comfortable with agreeing that we have no public hearings until after the september board meeting uh and i will take the superintendent at her word that you know we can be draft ready and uh begin the public process and i will still have that slight glimmer of hope although very dim glimmer that i'll finish in november but worst case is i guess it'll be new year's but much as that will pain me you know that's something uh i could deal

[05:07:07] with so mr. Hanson thank you mr. president and I agree with both your comments and the one thing that I would find really helpful in this next month is I'm not sure what the public documents especially for parents are going to be I did get a little bit of a sense that parents were an afterthought over the last two years and maybe that was just my misimpression of again it's not to take away from the work

or anything but I think at this point you know even the survey of the kids i thought it was interesting and if not learning those three big

[05:07:43] pieces of the pie then what but i think if you surveyed parents those would probably be the three things that they would want the most of and i think as our ultimate customer we i just and we talked very early today about just all of the acronyms and everything and just how daunting you know public meetings are to parents and um and i just i'm not sure what type of distillation of the 400 pages or of this 100 page powerpoint is going to be put out there so that this there's actually a productive tool for parents to understand you know when you have the rationale

[05:08:22] form data it just would i think be very helpful to the public to really understand what's in this what's not in this, what's different, what's changing, why it's changing, and just instead of asking people like us the last few weeks to be pouring through 6,000 pages of information, I think we owe it to the public, we owe it to the parents to be able to put this in layman's terms for what is before them and what they're being asked to discern and to discuss and

[05:08:59] to figure out and so to me if we had one thing that comes out of the next month that would be the most important thing of what we're putting out publicly and again not just plopping out 400 pages and expecting people we're very busy raising their two three four five kids working jobs in their communities and being able to be educated consumers what's coming up here. So, to me, that would be the most important thing of what we can get done in these next few weeks.

[05:09:31] I'm sorry, Mr. Mason. Can I address that? Sure. I'm glad that you brought that up, and I apologize for speaking over you. We had previously scheduled to have a virtual community engagement session through Zoom, along with eight community engagement round table sessions and one of the things that we wanted to do prior to starting those meetings, not this long PowerPoint, but as you said, in layman's terms, to go

[05:10:05] through the process, a recorded presentation so that you would have the option of kind of watching that recording prior to coming to the community round table sessions, and therefore that session you may have some background knowledge when you're sitting there the second thing it is a 400 page document and not only at those sessions what we are planning to have but also to break it break it apart so that we have on the doe website a history and social

[05:10:42] science review page so on that page we can break apart this document have the front matter in a course or the front matter and k through virginia studies because that's basically elementary so that you can download it as you as you like it not the whole 400 page document but also when we're in person at the community engagement sessions to have paper copies that's not the 400 page document but the front matter and course by course so that you can take it in you can pick up the course that

[05:11:18] you need so i i appreciate you bringing that up because that gave me an opportunity to tell you about our plans i hope where we are is the agreement to give the department a month we will come back in september you know i'm sorry science teacher but we have a recent history teacher okay that's all right sorry grace i thought you were still scratching no no no i'm done scratching my head um i really did want to take the opportunity to hear what others had to say before i just kind of jumped in but um you know having been licensed in the commonwealth for

[05:11:57] over 20 years now in this particular subject matter um christania having been uh a colleague of mine in norfolk public schools um and now you know meeting once again in this this world um i do just have a couple of points to make um because i was a part of the external review committees that did work for the 2015 um rewrite so i am very well aware of that process and also and having

[05:12:29] been a part of that process in in repeated capacities um you know spending time i i felt was honing my craft even more but knowing that i was a part of the process to help the board along their way in getting to the very best standards. I never expected that the board wouldn't go through their own work and evolution of that work that I had done back in those years. What I will say

[05:13:03] has nothing to do with anything political or content-based right now. It is very much a pedagogical observation here, and that is that history is inherently chronological.

[05:13:26] While themes are really a great opportunity to teach students large ideas, it's also important that chronology really does support really strong student understanding and connections as we move from what we want them to do is be able to reflect and build on kindergarten all the way through 12th grade in our history and social science standards

[05:14:01] and curriculum. And so I have real concerns around additionally the skills progression because having been a seventh and eighth grade teacher for over 10 years of students in a vast spectrum from BAP students all the way to gifted students, I think there's not enough emphasis

[05:14:30] on analysis and application of understanding and skills development here. Those kids in those grades and i would argue even in lower grades have a across the board an ability to do much more application and analysis analysis than we're asking them to do um in these standards um and then finally uh to the superintendent's point i think there are some pieces that we may be missing from

[05:15:06] an overarching standpoint and i will direct um attention to k um kb and kc if we're not exploring for kindergartners the basis of what a map is but then we're jumping into an awareness of places located in their community we have a lot of kids that don't don't have globes and maps in their homes um you know just like we talk about literacy and other capacities uh we aren't accounting for

[05:15:45] the different challenges of how students come to us and so i think that those are important things to reflect on as we move even deeper into this review a continual review until we get to what i would never want to call a final resting point i would want to call it a continual improvement so those are my comments thank you again i also wanted to listen in depth and i'm actually encouraged i i don't necessarily think that our perspectives are mutually exclusive

[05:16:20] i think that there's a couple things you know i absolutely if we're going to apply information we have to learn it so we have to have information i also i think we already picked up with that the quality of this presentation um and whether it is the excerpt of this meeting that's done or a separate self-contained video going through the process i i think it is very very helpful for anybody who's going to come to a round table or participate in things that they have the opportunity to understand the process and the context because again you've got to know facts if you're going to think critically about them so i i think that's that's very encouraging i mean in practical sense this this document is already on the street and i know in the districts that i'm

[05:17:00] i work closely with staff is already going through these and thinking about these and they have they have things they want to say so they're excited about this process i think this this community

engagement roundtable is is going to be a very healthy step and and i i do think that all this stuff can kind of be scheduled in in a very productive timely timely manner so again i i i think uh i think the end point you know might might take a little longer um but i think really the information is already out there so that the process you know how whatever we call the the the milepost on this trail that the trail we're on that um there's an opportunity now to go ahead

[05:17:40] and begin scheduling the engagement be doing the cleaning up and and and for us to to come back together so because again the other thing that christine said at the very very beginning was as the board we do indeed have the last say and and we cannot be compelled to have that last say on any given month so i think there's absolutely the capacity to do this right because it's worth doing well for the sake of doing it right but i i so i i've enjoyed this conversation i've enjoyed listening because i don't think anything here is mutually exclusive i think uh this process needs to keep going i think almost like the lab school piece there's energy and enthusiasm out

[05:18:15] there to to we need to get the people who have already been looking since our canceled july meeting at this information that information desire and review is there that we need to begin receiving it and processing it. Okay. I think the plan is that we work September.

[05:18:39] There may not be a full presentation in September. Let's go ahead and at least schedule out the board section of the public engagement or at the public meetings around the state for between the September and October meetings. If that schedule needs to shift for some reason, that's shiftable. I mean, but at least let's get them ironed out now, right, so that we don't lose that time uh and like i said you know madam superintendent thank you for agreeing to have the product back to us in september and we'll see where we go of course um christania how

[05:19:17] how quickly are are you all expecting to give somewhat of a crosswalk or when will when do you even have a draft of a crosswalk no because the the um standards need to be approved first we could very well start one and it's not it's not what what it is um our goal even if there there is a delay like january february our goal was to develop that crosswalk start on it as soon as we

[05:19:54] are approved and hopefully be able to have it by the 23 24 school year begins um so that people can get ready for transition between yes if i may just say one thing and so thank you i appreciate uh superintendent bell below i i will appreciate this extra time i do work a nine to five jobs and but i'd like to be thorough and read every page i have tried to do that with the other agenda items

[05:20:30] today and i would like to go through every page i'm not an educator but i'd like to know what what you know it it affects it would affect my kids or their kids and virginia and so i do i did not get a chance to go through um all of it but i i went through some of it i i just do have very deep issues with a lot of the content and it's just um it's it's it should be simple and concise and clear and balanced and reasonable it's some of it's very jargon heavy and it's just um i have a

[05:21:05] lot of comments about it so i will hold on to those um we will flush them out more we will have plenty of time to go over content yeah my comments before should not be read or heard to say we're not going to do content for today's purposes it was scheduling we will get in mr president yes ma'am may i suggest am i right i should say if people already have particular content suggestions um that they can send them in to the department uh you know line by line now you know do that later

[05:21:41] but you can start doing that now if you want or is that not the right way to go well i think if there are and i'll let christine you weigh on this too if they're sort of in the category of errors or perceived errors right send them in let's correct the typos and the misspellings if there and all that. If there's going to be an effort, though, to sort of change focus, and I'll use this as an example. If, for example, there's an effort to go more facts-based and inquiry-based in certain areas, and those are the types of corrections, I mean, honestly, that change can't be done by staff,

[05:22:19] right? That's a change the board is going to have to agree to, and I would prefer those types of higher-level things come back to the board. And so use some judgment. Obviously, things that just are wrong, you know, just send a quick note so that we don't go out with a document that's just wrong. But the higher-level concepts, you know, I think need to come back here because it's not really staff's job to resolve those.

[05:22:44] President Gecker? Do you disagree with that? I mean, it's good. Thank you. Got it. Yeah. Maybe I can just kind of help wrap things up and say, you know, probably Friday, Chris, Donya, and team and I can sit down. And I know all of us have been taking lots of notes And, you know, in particular, I think we will be talking about a process for roundtables and what that looks like.

[05:23:11] And I really, really appreciate the input from board members to think about incorporating part of today's presentation, but also making sure that the information is distilled enough so that a 9-to-5 mom or dad or grandma or grandpa can understand what some of the themes are and can answer maybe a questionnaire like the students did that said what's really important for kids to know and be able to demonstrate in history and social science and so i hope that we can have a discussion um based on today's discussion what those round tables might

[05:23:48] look like um the other thing that we we will offer that maybe maybe gets to the question you asked me um dan and that is that you know we're we're offering board orientations on topics for all of the board members and this seems like a perfect place for either new board members or seasoned board members to ask maybe some more of those granular questions and maybe they're not those big questions like inquiry based versus fact based, chronological versus thematic, but maybe they're questions like I don't really see a theme of religious freedom

[05:24:23] in third grade. Can you explain to me how that would be taught? And those are the kinds of questions that i i think are are perfectly appropriate for either a briefing for public or for comments that board members might want to send send in or give to us give to me give to you or that we discuss as a as a board um this is the the questions and the comments and the input from the board members are incredibly incredibly important every day um but from from this moment on I just want want you all to know that that we're open for business and ready to take those

[05:25:01] comments and and president gecker um and all members of the board what what a thoughtful conversation after a a great presentation and we appreciate it and truly truly i'll end where i started and that is we are on our way to having the best standards in the nation and i don't want any of us to settle for anything less all right with that i'm hopeful we can move on thank you good superintendent and christina thank you and the team really appreciate y'all being here and great work thank you and thank you president geckerman that was a for facilitate conversation

[05:25:37] like that that allowed it that's uh fantastic all right all right yep uh we have one more item before executive session i'm proposing we do that item then take a quick break and then we will move into

executive session uh just to tell you guys a quick story in 2000 i was appointed to the the Chesterfield Planning Commission, my first meeting on the commission started at noon and ended at 2.35 in the morning. So you guys, you got nothing going on here. I don't want to hear

[05:26:08] any whining or complaining. Welcome back. Yep, bringing up the rear here. Not hardly. We're happy to have you back. Okay, item J, first review of an amendment to Virginia's consolidated state plan under the, under ESSA, Amendment 5. Mr. President, can I interrupt just to say I'm so sorry that I have to duck out for a prior engagement and i'm so sorry also not to have been there to welcome new board members in person great to be with you all all by zoom and i will see you in september

[05:26:45] and what if i said no you got to stay i don't know how how large your reach is across the all right have fun see you later ma'am so today is a first review of an amendment uh which is actually amendment five to virginia's uh consolidated state plan and for those of you that are not familiar with the consolidated state plan it is a plan where we provide information

[05:27:21] on how we meet the requirements of essa and how it's implemented in um in virginia so as a fair warning i do want to say that anytime we discuss the essa consolidated state plan there's a lot of details in there a lot of people aren't familiar with a lot of the details and it's also quarter to six so I will try to give enough context to understand but if you're you don't dig into it every day it is a little bit daunting so there

[05:27:56] are six proposed changes to the consolidated state plan and this first change is the addition of a multiple races student group for reporting so under federal accountability we have different indicators they're different indicators than we have in the accreditation system but these indicators report out by student group and so ESSA does require that when we have a major racial or ethnic group that we report out and what determines

[05:28:32] a major racial or ethnic group is state determined and in Virginia we use the definition that if 5% or more of the student population is a particular race or ethnicity that that's a major student group and multiple races meets that criteria and that's really a student record that has two or more races um identified on it this was placed into our accreditation system in april 2019

[05:29:06] so this is to add the multiple races student group into federal accountability all right the second change is really a technical edit to step three of the csi and tsi identification process so there are some federal accountability indicators that we have that are used to identify schools for support and improvement comprehensive

[05:29:42] support and improvement targeted support and improvement and additional targeted support and improvement are three different categories where we identify schools to offer them support and so we use performance on some of these federal indicators to identify these schools so there's a three-step process for CSI and TSI which you can see on the screen and it it looks like a funnel so if a school doesn't meet a criteria in a step it's removed from the funnel so that by the

[05:30:18] time you get to the end of that step three the schools that remain are those that are eligible for support so um the technical edit that we need to make is to step three of the process for both csi and tsi and in in order to explain what that edit is um you would need to be familiar with our triennial accreditation and what that is is it's in the standards of quality and what that states is that if a school is accredited for three years three consecutive

[05:30:58] years it's then accredited for the following three consecutive years so what happens is a school can actually be accredited under this triennial accreditation but then it can also earn a level three which would normally put it in an accredited accredited with condition status but it's not going to have that status is going to have the the status of accredited because it's under triennial accreditation so what this edit does is it basically makes sure that we are looking at

[05:31:39] the most recent years data when we are looking to see whether a school meets that criteria of being accredited and then they would be removed from the funnel but if they're not accredited based on that most recent year's data they would stay in the funnel does that make sense all right um proposed change three is a revision of the growth methodology

[05:32:14] for the 2022-2023 federal accountability year in our current consolidated state plan there is two indicators growth for english reading and growth for mathematics and that indicator includes students who pass the state assessments and then it also includes students who have shown growth from the previous year's sol test and as you may be aware we have started to

[05:32:49] administer growth assessments for the first time in fall of 2021 and so the proposal is to incorporate those growth assessments into federal accountability as they are in the accreditation system so originally our original intent was to put into the federal accountability system, a growth measure that matched what we do on the accreditation side. And so what we were

[05:33:23] doing this year is if a student failed a spring 22 SOL test, we compared it to the previous spring SOL test to determine whether there was growth. If that did not show growth, we then compared that spring 22 score to the fall 21 growth assessment, and we determined whether there was growth.

[05:33:48] so that's how we determine growth on the accreditation side and our original intent was to make that growth methodology the same on the federal accountability side i did submit this amendment as kind of an early look document to uscd they sent back feedback that they didn't feel that that methodology would work for federal accountability and they suggested that what we do

[05:34:19] is we compare the failing spring 22 score to the previous spring 21 score and to determine whether there was growth and only if there wasn't a spring 21 score could we use the fall score so i have reached out for additional clarification from them and i i do believe that they will probably work with us a little bit in terms of flexibility but where it stands right now

[05:34:59] the guidance was that we couldn't use the accreditation version of growth but i will not know for sure what will happen until i come back in september with the final review and so i'll have one of those two methodologies in the final version all right the next one this actually was proposed change that was approved by the board in i believe it was june where there was a covet 19

[05:35:37] amendment that the uscd allowed states to make some changes to their plan based on the pandemic and so one of the things that they allowed was for schools to shift their measures of interim progress forward two years for indicators. So some of the federal indicators in the ESSA plan

[05:36:06] have measures of interim progress and long-term goals. Some of them do not. So what occurs is you start out at a baseline and then you have certain intervals where the number increases from where you start to where you want to get in year seven and that's kind of the measures of interim progress along the way um this proposed change number four was to shift the measures of

[05:36:41] interim progress forward two years for chronic absenteeism the federal graduation index and english learner progress and the reason we're shifting it forward two years is to account for the two years in which accountability was waived due to the pandemic so i will show you what that means on this next um on this next slide so this is are the measures of interim progress and the long-term goal for l progress so as you can see on the two uh columns that are highlighted gray

[05:37:19] those were the two years accountability was waived so in year three the original year three target there there was no testing that year so those actual goals that we were shooting for have been shifted forward two years and so the goals uh or the targets that were in place for the 2020-21 accountability year are now the goals for this year so that did get approved in the

[05:37:52] covid 19 amendment and the board did approve that previously but since this is a long-term change uscd has asked that we put it in our consolidated state plan all right proposed change number five is new measures of interim progress and long-term goals for reading and mathematics so under esca they require that states have measures of interim progress and long-term goals based on

[05:38:31] student performance on the state's current assessment and this um this year we did have new vap assessments in reading and mathematics and we actually administered in the new reading assessment to a full representative population of students this year in 2122 when we administered it the previous year that was when participation rates were low so these new targets that the new measures of interim progress and the

[05:39:10] long-term goals that we've set do raise the expectations for all student groups and it does place an increased focus on closing achievement gaps I'm going to review the reading and the math targets and the long-term goals and table format on the next couple of slides but I do want you to keep in mind these points as I share the new tables the first step in setting new targets is setting a baseline measure from which to grow so you need something for a year one for

[05:39:47] For the new re-established baselines, the measures for each student group are set at the pass rate of the school at the 50th percentile of enrollment using the 21-22 school year data.

[05:40:03] The pass rate of the school at the 20th percentile of enrollment was used in the past. This is an increase in expectations, but it's also appropriate based on the performance of the students in the 21-22 assessments.

[05:40:18] The long-term goals for both reading and mathematics have been increased for all student groups. So in reading, the previous long-term goal was 75% and that matched the state's benchmark.

[05:40:33] Now the long-term goal is 88%. And in math, the previous long-term goal was 70% and that again matched the state accreditation benchmark but that goal is now 85 percent you're going to see on these tables that the same long term goals exist for all the student groups and this really does increase the intensity and the urgency of closing the achievement gaps since the lower performing student groups have greater

[05:41:07] overall increases to make towards the same long-term goal than the higher performing groups and they have to do so within the same time frame so we'll look at the reading targets first and the long-term goals you'll notice on this table that the baseline year from which to grow is labeled year one and it's based on data from the 21-22 school year again this baseline was based on the pass rate of the schools at the fifth of the school at the 50th percentile of enrollment

[05:41:47] so to help interpret that look at the baseline for black students and that baseline is 60 so that indicates that 50 of black students in virginia are in a school that has a pass rate of 60 or below you'll also notice that each student group has the same long-term goal the long-term goal is determined by subtracting the baseline year pass rate for the all student

[05:42:22] groups so we're looking at the 75 and we're subtracting that from a hundred percent proficiency we're dividing that number in half and then adding it to the baseline so what we're essentially doing is closing the difference between the baseline and a hundred percent proficiency by 50 over these seven years the determination of long-term goals again is a different methodology than we previously used because we did use the benchmarks that were aligned with accreditation

[05:42:59] you'll notice the measures of interim progress for years two through six for each student grouped were determined by subtracting the baseline pass rate from the long-term goal and then dividing that into intervals so that you we um there was a steady increase from year one to year seven where you see asterisks on the table is where the performance of a group may meet or exceed what the long-term goal is so those groups still do have to make progress and they have to

[05:43:36] show progress um each each year and the last point um that i want to reiterate is that the measures of interim progress require some student groups to make greater overall increases towards the same long-term goal within the same time frame than other groups and the measures of interim progress for groups with a lower baseline have larger intervals relative to groups that have a higher baseline so for example the baseline for english learners is 47 and the student group is expected

[05:44:14] to increase six to seven points per year to meet the long-term goal in year seven and you can compare that for instance to black students they begin at 60 and they're expected to increase four to five points per year to meet that long-term goal and again having the same long-term goal or expectation for all student groups places emphasis on the necessity and the urgency to close the gaps between student groups the next slide has the table for mathematics and the same

[05:44:49] points i made on the previous reading table apply to this table as well you will notice that long term goal is 85% using the same methodology to close the gap by 50% between the 70 and 100% proficiency. And then the very last edit that I am proposing is just an edit to a reference year,

[05:45:29] a year that's referenced in the document. This, again, was something that was approved in the COVID-19 addendum. And basically, schools that are additional targeted and support for a certain amount of time, if they don't exit, they then turn into comprehensive support and improvement schools.

[05:45:51] And under the COVID-19 addendum, we did extend that period of time where they could remain in that ATSI period or that status before they entered a CSI by a year.

[05:46:06] So again, that was previously approved, but we are just putting it in this document because it was mentioned. So with all of that, I will take questions 'cause I'm sure there's probably some.

[05:46:22] - You're looking at me. Yes, I do have questions. Sorry, in that last slide, what was the change 2018-19? what year was the change last slide the last yeah oops i'm sorry so um so under our current guidelines if a school was identified in the 2018-19 school year as needing additional targeted

[05:47:00] support and improvement if they didn't um meet the criteria to exit that um that status by fall of 2024 they would then go into comprehensive support and improvement so in the covid19 addendum we

extended that period which still fell under state guidelines to allow them to be in atsi status another year before they would be put into csi status so that was um changed to

[05:47:38] yeah so instead of 2024 it's 2020 yeah does that make sense yeah yeah yeah sorry it wasn't clear um you reached in in i guess sorry the fourth slide you said that you reached out to the uscd for a clarification what clarification have you reached out to them so um we have somebody specifically at uscd who is assigned to us as a state and so we'll frequently speak with them about any changes that we have anything that's about to come up so that they're aware

[05:48:15] of what we're thinking and it also helps when you do submit something for them to give you feedback so that you know what to present to the board or what would be acceptable etc so um i floated by our change and gave them an early look especially now since um this is really kind of under a very tight um time constraint because we do need to identify schools for csi and tsi for this upcoming

[05:48:52] fall by the end of september so i knew we were short on time so i gave them an early look at this document and that is when i received the feedback um but again i i did reach out after that in hopes that yeah got it thank you two more questions yeah won't take too long for the ones for the groups student groups that already meet the the standards the rates um what progress do they have to make you mentioned that they still do have to make they do still have to make progress

[05:49:28] so it really matter it really so like if we look at this reading um table and we look at the asian students and we see that um in year one they have uh what does that say 90 can't see 91 thank you the following year their rate has to be greater than 91 in order to meet the target so if it was 92 that would be enough if it was 93 the following year in year three it would have to be greater than

[05:50:07] 93 so it's just they need to be improving meeting or improving year to year okay so it cannot stay at 91 no okay and sorry the last one yep is the third slide where you had that inverted triangle yep um could you explain that last bottom thing to me one more time how they can move out so that last um that last step the csi and tsi yeah i'm gonna make i'm gonna grab my version that's a

[05:50:47] little bit bigger if you don't mind yeah so uh that very last step after you go through steps one and two that very last step uh states that um for the schools that are still on that funnel we're going to keep you in the funnel if you don't meet the measures of interim progress for chronic absenteeism and you're not accredited using the most recent school years data so if you don't meet if you're still in that funnel and then you don't meet chronic absenteeism

[05:51:27] and you're not accredited you stay in the funnel so the reason why we have that language change is because the old language said something to the effect of let me see i wrote it down it used to say they don't meet the chronic absenteeism and have an soa standards of accreditation rating of accredited with conditions or accreditation denied which meant they had indicators that were in the red were in level three but with our triennial

[05:52:04] accreditation legislation a school could actually be accredited under that triennial accreditation and if they earn a level three in a particular year they're still it's still going to say accredited because they're under that triennial accreditation period and we wanted to be able to keep those schools in the funnel if they needed support so does this mean for three years you're going to give them a chance or no say it again they're still going to get a chance even if

[05:52:41] they're they don't meet the credit accreditation for the most recent year right so we want to use the data from the most recent year so if a school has um level three rate or uh level three performance levels we want that school to stay in the funnel because they need support but if they were under triennial accreditation they could have that status of accredited and have those level threes and with the language that was there it just wasn't clear that we were really using current

[05:53:19] year's data and saying if you have a level three we want you to stay in the funnel so it's just kind of a technical edit thank you so um in other words it's it provides greater transparency to the public about what exactly is going on in that school um so for example if their test scores if they're not meeting the indicators within the accreditation model, then they don't get to just

[05:53:53] stay there. They don't get to keep the accredited label. They have to be transparent about the fact that they are not meeting those standards appropriately. So this increases the accountability of those schools that may be missing the mark but while it's also while they're missing the mark this is also the opportunity for support to help those schools not just drop off

[05:54:29] but hey let's help you to move on up the chain again instead of saying we're done you understand Okay. And so how many years are you giving them a chance then still? So triennial accreditation is for a three-year period. So any of those, so for instance, a school, let's just hypothetically, a school this year that was under triennial accreditation, and this is their last year that they were on it. Okay. So this was year three that they had earned.

[05:55:03] Well, if they had level three indicators this year, technically they're accredited, but really when we look at their data, it shows that they need support. And we want those schools to stay in the funnel because those are the schools that do need our support.

[05:55:26] So the edit is just an edit to say, we're going to look at your data and see how your data compares to the accreditation benchmarks and that's the data we're using to determine whether you're in the funnel or not we're not going to worry about whether you're triennial under triennial accreditation or not we just want to look at your data and if it supports that you need to stay in the funnel then you should stay in the funnel thank you yes uh you

[05:56:02] staff does such a great job all day and i'm also just would commend the board for the job because really y'all we just definitely handled for like two hours with expert facilitation a very complex state issue and now we've just jumped into the deep end of the pool of federal regulation and and so i just would say bless our hearts and i've been and i've been working on federal accreditation stuff for years so yes i think maybe i'm going to try to say it this way um to my colleague and you tell me if this is right so triennial accreditation was intended to be a way to benefit consistently high-performing schools by not making them jump through so many hoops every single year

[05:56:40] so they could actually focus on going to the next level. And so that was it. It was just trying to relieve consistently high-performing schools of federal burden. However, I think the feds are saying that if suddenly you're not high-performing anymore, then that deal should be off. And so I kind of think that's what's happening here. And I think that probably that makes good sense. A lot of the stuff is weighing in the weeds. I'm real thrilled that even, you know, we've tried for years for a time the feds referred to our the groups of students as subgroups and then always just made it by skin crawl because children not sub anything so I'm so glad that even now in our federal application we're talking about groups

[05:57:16] of students so I think that's that's fantastic and and you know but but to these changes these growth measures one thing to be growing but also be growing towards something and so I think that's what the charts really point out something to know that my middle son grew an inch but if he was still like you know two standard deviations behind you know we might need to see it see a doctor so I think yeah this is so so and for for you to have to present to us when we're all so tired federal stuff I think the important thing here is is that it ends with the superintendent's recommendation that we say in the feds good graces and

[05:57:53] it looks like this has been a way to do it but my goodness what a deep deep dive so bless our hearts and this is on first review so you will have another chance to look at in September. In that spirit, I want to thank Shelly and Amy. Bless their hearts because they're in my office a lot as I ask lots and lots and lots of questions and I appreciate their patience and they have they have a narrow path with federal regulations and they have that anyway and then add in the state superintendent saying we can't do that we've got to we've got to keep raising the ceiling and raising the floor and so how do we figure that out and that's where

[05:58:33] we are today just a comment yeah i appreciate you saying raising the floor and raising the ceiling this is good work i support the superintendent's recommendation i appreciate the presentation particularly as dr siebert said this point in the day but these numbers should these targets should sober us up for two reasons one like where we are and how much work there is to do and then second like that work's not just going to happen because we want it to or because we like there's there's just an incredible pace of school improvement embedded in these numbers and

[05:59:08] we should be attentive to that thank you both for the presentation i think what the board is going

[05:59:16] to do is take 10 minutes be back 6 25 for executive session mr rotherham i think you've got a motion

[06:09:06] to make yes mr president i move the pursuant of virginia code 2.2-3711 a 40 the virginia board of education convene in a closed meeting for the purposes of discussion and consideration of of records related to denial, suspension, or revocation of teacher licenses, and the Deb Love Legal Counsel to the Board of Education, as well as staff members Jillian Ballow, Joan Johnson, Kevin Foster, Stephen Burkhart, whose presence will aid the Board's consideration of this matter, also participate in the closed meeting.

[06:09:34] Thank you. Thank you. We have a motion to start a second. Thank you. All those in favor signify by saying aye. Aye. Aye. Thank you. Any opposed? All right. The Board is in closed session. Is the room...

